


USER MANUAL

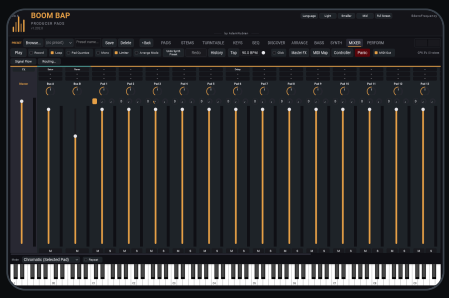
# Boom Bap Producer Pads

Version 1.202.0 · VST3, CLAP and Standalone for Windows

A pad sampler and sequencer built for boom bap: pads, a step sequencer with groove, a synth, a bass line that slides, two turntables, stems and a mixer with buses — all in one instrument.







EdensFrequency

by **AdamNubian**

distributed by EdensFrequency

edensfrequency.github.io/boom-bap-producer-pads

# Contents


| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Welcome** | What it is, and the words you'll meet | 3 |
| 02 | **Installing** | Requirements, the installer, getting your DAW to see it | 4 |
| 03 | **A quick tour** | The ten tabs, and your first beat | 6 |
| 04 | **The toolbar** | Presets, transport, undo, tempo, Master FX | 8 |
| 05 | **Pads and the sample browser** | Loading and playing sounds, banks, grid sizes | 11 |
| 06 | **Kit import and export** | SoundFont, SFZ, DecentSampler, sliced WAV, FL Studio | 17 |
| 07 | **The Sample Editor** | Trim, chop, slice, record and Grab | 19 |
| 08 | **A pad's sound controls** | Filter, envelope, pitch, effects, Mod and Grain | 22 |
| 09 | **SEQ: the step sequencer** | Patterns, groove, generators, exports, Roll | 29 |
| 10 | **KEYS** | The synth part and each pad's melody | 35 |
| 11 | **SYNTH** | A synthesiser to play, and its presets | 42 |
| 12 | **BASS** | A bass line that slides | 46 |
| 13 | **MIXER** | Strips, Duck, buses, routing, the master | 49 |
| 14 | **ARRANGE** | Turning banks into a song | 54 |
| 15 | **TURNTABLE** | Two decks, Deck Chop, stems, Vinyl Sim | 56 |
| 16 | **STEMS** | Band and harmonic/percussive splits | 62 |
| 17 | **DISCOVER** | Your crate, folders, YouTube Crate, Convert | 64 |
| 18 | **MIDI Learn** | Knobs on your controller | 68 |
| 19 | **Using a DJ controller** | Jogs, faders and pads on the decks | 69 |
| 20 | **Saving and the Standalone** | Projects, presets, running without a DAW | 75 |
| 21 | **Languages** | Choosing one, and translating the plugin | 77 |
| 22 | **License** | What you may do with it | 78 |

CHAPTER 01

# Welcome

Boom Bap Producer Pads is a beat-making instrument for your computer. Load sounds onto pads, play them, program beats and bass lines, play and write parts for a built-in synth, sample records on two built-in turntables, and mix it all. It runs inside music software (as a VST3 or CLAP plugin) or on its own as a standalone app, on Windows.

These docs are written for musicians, not programmers.

## Words you'll see

- **DAW**: your music software (FL Studio, Ableton Live, Reason, Bitwig...).
- **Plugin (VST3 / CLAP)**: a program that runs *inside* a DAW. VST3 and CLAP are two plug shapes; your DAW supports at least one of them.
- **Standalone**: the plugin running as its own app, with no DAW needed.
- **Sample**: a recorded sound, like a drum hit, a vocal phrase, or a slice of a record.
- **Pad**: one of the squares in the grid. Each holds a sample and plays it when hit.
- **Bank**: a whole set of pads with their patterns, like a separate kit. There are four (A-D).
- **Chop**: cutting a sample into pieces, each on its own pad.
- **Pattern / step sequencer**: a loop of 16 steps where you switch on the moments a pad should play.
- **BPM**: beats per minute, the tempo. **Key**: the musical key a sound is in.
- **MIDI**: the language music gear uses to talk to computers. A **MIDI controller** is a keyboard or pad controller that sends it.
- **Preset**: your whole setup saved under a name, to reload anywhere.
- **Stems**: separate parts of a sound, like its low end, its hits vs its sustained notes, or a record's vocals, drums and bass.
- **Synth**: an instrument that makes its sound from scratch (no sample), played from a keyboard.
- **Bus**: a channel several sounds go through together, so one effect or fader treats them all.

CHAPTER 02

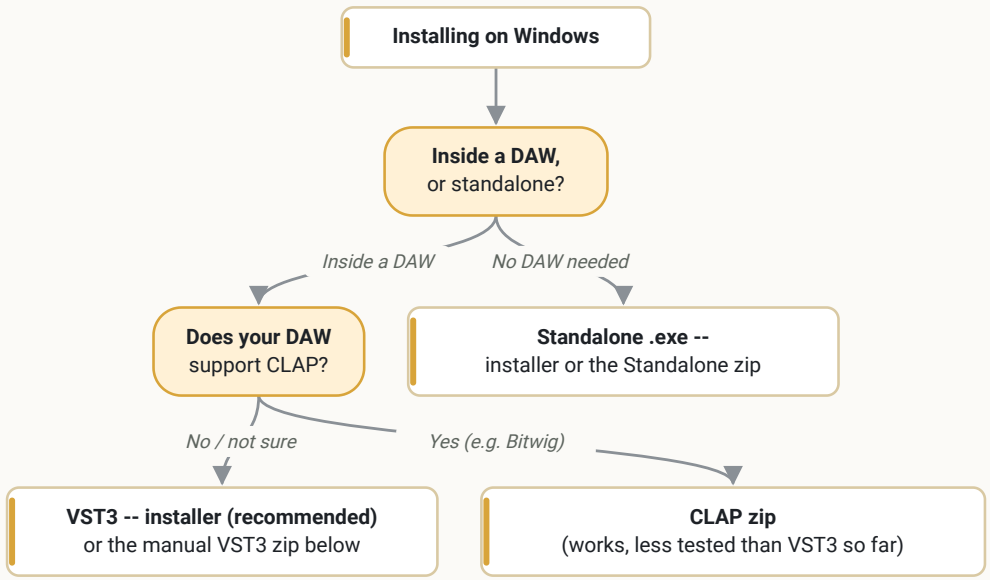
# Installing

Windows only: VST3, CLAP and a standalone app.

## Requirements

- A VST3 host: Reason, FL Studio, or Ableton Live confirmed working. Others that support VST3 should work too but haven't been tested yet. **Not** required for the standalone app below — it runs entirely on its own.
- A CLAP build is also available (`Boom Bap Producer Pads.clap.zip` on the Releases page) for hosts that support the CLAP format (e.g. Bitwig) — less tested than the VST3 build so far, but the same plugin either way.

## Which path do I want?




## Recommended: the installer

Download `BoomBapProducerPadsSetup-X.Y.Z.exe` from the project's Releases page and run it. The wizard installs both the VST3 (into the shared system VST3 folder every host scans, or a folder you choose) and the standalone app, and silently installs the WebView2 Runtime if it isn't already on your system (needed for the DISCOVER tab's YouTube embed — most Windows 11 machines already have it). It never touches your presets, DISCOVER crate, or settings, even when reinstalling over an existing version.

A **Check for Updates** shortcut is added to the Start Menu alongside the app — it checks for a newer release and, if one exists, downloads and runs the same installer wizard.

The sections below are the manual alternative — useful if you want full control over exactly what gets copied where.

## As a VST3 plugin (inside a DAW), manually

1. Get `Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3` — download the latest `Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3.zip` from the project's Releases page and unzip it.
2. Copy the whole `Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3` folder into your system's VST3 folder: `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\`.
3. Rescan plugins in your DAW:
   - **FL Studio**: Options → Manage Plugins → Find/rescan plugins. Look for "Boom Bap Producer Pads" under Generators (it's an instrument).
   - **Ableton Live**: Preferences → Plug-Ins → make sure VST3 is enabled, then rescan (or refresh the browser's Plug-Ins list).
   - **Reason**: Preferences → Advanced/VST → enable VST3 plugins and rescan, then add it as an instrument device.
4. If you already had a previous version loaded in an open project, remove and re-add the plugin instance (or restart the DAW) — some hosts keep the old binary mapped in memory even after a rescan.

## As a standalone app (no DAW needed)

Download `Boom Bap Producer Pads-Standalone.zip` from the Releases page (or build the project yourself, which also produces `Boom Bap Producer Pads.exe`) and run the `.exe` directly — no install step, no host to configure. On first launch, open its audio settings to pick an output device (and a MIDI input device if you want to play it from a controller). See usage/saving-and-standalone.md for the one behavioural difference from running inside a DAW (the step sequencer needs its own "Seq Play" toggle, since there's no host transport to follow).

## Troubleshooting

- **Plugin doesn't appear after rescanning**: confirm the folder is really at `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3\` and not nested inside itself (e.g. `...\Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3\Boom Bap Producer Pads.vst3\...`) — some file managers/scripts can nest a folder copy if the destination already exists. Delete the whole thing and copy fresh if in doubt.
- **Old version still showing**: the plugin binary can be locked by a running DAW that already has it loaded. Close the DAW (or remove that plugin instance) before replacing the file, then reopen.
- **Standalone app has no sound**: open its audio settings (usually a small icon/menu in the window) and confirm the right output device is selected — it doesn't inherit any system default automatically the first time.

CHAPTER 03

# A quick tour

The plugin has ten tabs, switched via the buttons in the toolbar strip (top-left, next to the preset controls): **PADS**, **STEMS**, **TURNTABLE**, **KEYS**, **SEQ**, **DISCOVER**, **ARRANGE**, **BASS**, **SYNTH** and **MIXER**. The preset bar and output meter stay visible on every tab, and a **< Back** button next to them walks back through your last few tab switches. The banner shows the installed version number (e.g. `v1.123.0`) directly under the plugin name — check it before reporting a bug, since the fix you're looking for might already be in a newer build.




*The PADS tab — the default view*




## Your first beat, in six steps

If you've never used a pad sampler before, this is the shortest path from nothing to a playing beat:

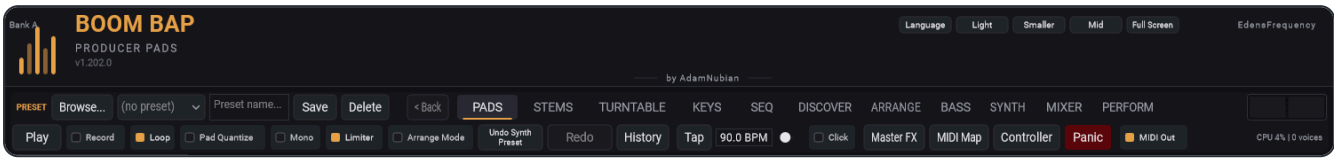
1. **Load sounds.** On the PADS tab, point the browser at a folder of drum sounds, or drag files onto pads. See Pads.
2. **Play them.** Click the pads, or hit them on a MIDI controller.

3. **Make a pattern.** On the SEQ tab, select the kick pad and light up some of the 16 steps, then do the same for the snare and hats. Or let **Generate...** write one for you. See SEQ tab.
4. **Press play in your DAW.** The pattern plays in time with your song (running standalone, use **Seq Play**).
5. **Shape and balance.** Tweak each pad on the PADS tab, then balance everything on the MIXER tab. See DSP controls and MIXER.
6. **Save it.** Save your DAW project, or save a preset to reuse the kit anywhere. See saving-and-standalone.md.

Want to sample a record instead? Put it on the TURNTABLE, press Play, and hit **Chop** on the beat. See Deck Chop.

CHAPTER 04

# The toolbar




*The banner and both toolbar rows*

Two rows below the banner. Row 1 holds the preset bar, the **< Back** button, and the tab buttons; row 2 holds transport, pattern-editing tools, and everything that used to spill off a single-row toolbar as the plugin grew. Both rows are visible on every tab.

## Row 1 — presets, back, tabs

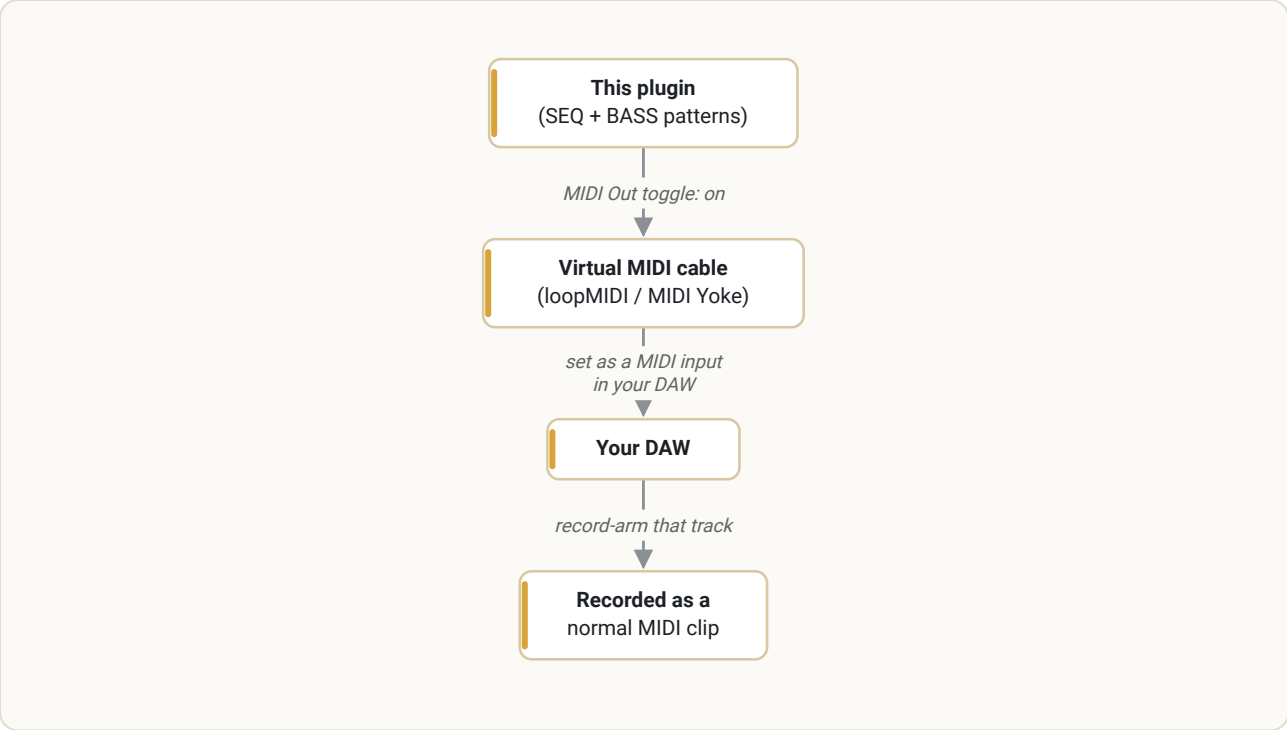
- **PRESET** dropdown — pick a saved preset to load it immediately.
- **Preset name** field + **Save** — type a name and click Save to store the current full kit as a preset: every pad's sample, all its DSP settings (filter, envelope, pitch, bitcrush, mute/solo, choke group, color, rename), all 4 banks (samples and patterns together, see Step sequencer), swing, and the turntable's own settings. Saving over an existing name overwrites it.
- **Browse...** (left of the preset list) — the sound browser: your kits (these presets) and synth sounds in one list. **Search** names, categories and tags; narrow it by kind, category or tag, or show only your **favourites** (click a star). Give the selected sound a **Category** and **Tags** ("dusty, warm, vinyl..."), then **Load** it (or double-click); a synth sound can go **To Bass** instead. **Undo** puts back what was there. The browser keeps its tags in its own file and never changes your preset files, and it opens where you left off.
- **Delete** — removes whichever preset is currently selected in the dropdown.
- **< Back** — returns to whichever tab you were on before your last few tab switches, walking further back each time you click it again (it doesn't create a new "forward" entry of its own, so it can't bounce you between the same two tabs).
- **PADS / STEMS / TURNTABLE / KEYS / SEQ / DISCOVER / ARRANGE / BASS / SYNTH / MIXER** — switch tabs. The active tab is highlighted in orange.
- **Meter** (far right) — live stereo output level. Turns red when clipping.

## Row 2 — transport, editing, tools

- **Play/Stop/REC** — the global transport button. Inside a real DAW this just reflects the host's own play/record state (a plugin generally can't command its host's transport) — the button text and colour follow along but clicking it has no effect there. Running standalone, it's a genuine Play/Stop for the whole plugin.
- **Record** — arms recording (the same armed state the PADS tab's own Record toggle shows); right-click for MIDI Learn like most toggles here. A hit goes on the step nearest where you played it. On the PADS tab, **Rec...** sets how: **Quantize strength** (100% puts hits right on the step; less keeps some of your timing, 0% all of it),

**Overdub** (add to what's there) or **Replace** (the first hit on a pad clears that pad's steps), and a **Count-in when Play starts** (Standalone). Hold **Erase** and hit pads to clear their steps as the playhead passes.

- **Loop** — toggles looped playback of whatever's currently previewing (the KEYS tab's pattern preview, for example) — not a host parameter, just a plain preference.
- **Pad Quantize** — when on, hitting a pad live (MIDI or a click) waits for the next beat instead of firing right away. Handy for performing along with the sequencer without your hits drifting off the grid. Sequencer steps aren't affected — they're already on the grid.
- **Mono** — when on, triggering any pad stops every other currently-sounding pad, kit-wide. Different from a pad's own Choke Group (right-click a pad to set one): Choke Group only cuts other pads sharing the same numbered group, Mono affects every pad at once with no grouping needed. A real parameter, so it's automatable and MIDI-learnable like anything else. Off by default.
- **Limiter** — a brick-wall limiter on the final master output, to catch accidental clipping when several pads, the bass, the synth and the decks all peak at once. On by default; it's in Export WAV too.
- **Arrangement Mode** — turns on the ARRANGEMENT tab's section timeline; while it's on, the SEQ tab's own bank buttons are disabled since the timeline drives bank switches instead.
- **Undo / Redo** — steps back (and forward) through the edits that change a lot at once: chopping and slicing (and moving or deleting a chop), Deck Chop, every **Generate...**, Randomize, Humanize, Euclid, Ghost notes, Flip, Clear Pattern, Clear Pad, Trim Silence and Import Kit — up to 20 levels. (The KEYS tab's synth part has its own undo.) Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y (Ctrl+Shift+Z also works for Redo) work from any tab. **History** opens a popup listing every step in the undo/redo stack by name, so you can see what you're about to step through instead of guessing.
- **Tap** — tap along to set the standalone tempo (standalone only; hidden inside a real DAW, where the host's own tempo already applies). The **BPM** field next to it does the same job by direct entry — type a number or drag it.
- **Click** — a metronome, standalone only, same visibility rule as Tap/BPM above (a real DAW already has its own click).
- **Master FX** — opens a small popup with 3 effect slots applied to your final mix, regardless of which tab is showing. Pick an effect type per slot. Reverb, Delay, Saturation, and Formant Shift slots also show real knobs (Size/Damping/Mix, Time/Feedback/Mix, Drive, or Shift) — adjustable, automatable, and MIDI-learnable like any other knob in the plugin. The same popup is also reachable from the MIXER tab's Master strip, via its own **FX** button.
- **MIDI Map** — opens a popup listing every active MIDI Learn CC mapping in the plugin in one place, so you can review or clear a binding without hunting down the control it's attached to. See MIDI Learn.
- **Controller** - opens the DJ controller window: teach the plugin your DJ controller's jog wheels, buttons, faders and pads so they play the decks and pads, and save it by name. See Using a DJ controller.
- **Panic** — immediately silences every playing pad, the bass and the SYNTH. For a stuck note during live use, not something you'd need routinely. (The decks keep playing: they aren't notes.)
- **MIDI Out** — on by default. While on, the pattern actually playing on the PADS grid and the BASS lane is also sent out as real, sample-accurate MIDI note-on/off (not just triggering this plugin's own audio) — useful if you want to capture what the plugin is generating as an editable MIDI clip. Getting it to actually land in your DAW's own piano roll generally needs a virtual MIDI cable (e.g. loopMIDI or MIDI Yoke): route this plugin's MIDI output to the virtual port, then set that same port as a MIDI input in your DAW and record it — that one-time setup happens in your DAW/OS, not in this plugin. If you just want a one-off pattern as a file instead, the SEQ and KEYS tabs both have their own MIDI export/drag options that don't need any of this.




- **CPU / voice count** (far right) — a live readout of processor load and how many voices are currently sounding.

## Banner strip (top, next to the logo)

- **Light / Dark** — switches the whole plugin between the dark theme and a light one (easier on the eyes in a bright room or in daylight). Every open window of the plugin switches at once, and it remembers your choice next time. The button shows the theme you'd switch *to*. The record on the turntable stays black either way.
- **Language** — the plugin's language. Pick one from the list (it's used the next time you open the plugin's window, and remembered), open the Languages folder, or make a template for translating it into yours. See Languages, and translating the plugin.
- **Smaller / Mid / Full Screen** — one-click window sizing. Full Screen fits your actual display, whatever size that is. The window is also still freely resizable by dragging any edge or corner, and always keeps its proportions while you do.
- A small readout next to the size buttons shows **Bank X** at all times, and — while Arrangement Mode is on — the current section's name and its position in the timeline (e.g. "Bank A - Chorus (2/5)"), so you always know where you are without switching to the ARRANGEMENT tab to check.

Scrolling over any knob (DSP panel, Turntable, or this toolbar's own BPM/ Swing/Volume/Pan sliders) nudges its value by a small, precise step — handy for fine adjustments without needing to drag.

Presets are stored per-user at `%APPDATA%/Boom Bap Producer Pads/Presets/*.bbpreset` — they're independent of any DAW project, so they carry across projects and sessions. Saving a preset also copies every sample it uses (across all 4 banks) into a `<preset name>_data/` folder alongside it, so the preset keeps working even if you later delete or move the original sample files — a common workflow once a one-shot from a "used samples" folder has done its job.

DAW project saves (not named presets) still reference your samples by their original file path, same as always.

CHAPTER 05

# Pads and the sample browser




*The PADS tab*

This is the main PADS view: sample browser on the left, the 4x4 pad grid in the middle, and the waveform/DSP column on the right, with the performance controls along the bottom and the keyboard under everything.

## Sample browser

Top-left panel.

- **Choose Folder...** — point the browser at your own sample library. Remembered across sessions.
- **Search** box — filters the visible tree by filename (case-insensitive substring match). Folders you already had open keep showing what they last scanned until you collapse and reopen them; newly opened folders always reflect the current search.
- **Double-click a file** to load it onto whichever pad is currently selected.
- Dragging a file *out of* this browser and onto a pad isn't supported yet — drag from Windows Explorer or your DAW's own browser instead (see below), or double-click.

### Dropping files anywhere

Drag audio or video from Windows Explorer (or your DAW's browser) onto:

- **a pad** — loads it onto that pad;
- **the Sample Editor** — loads it onto the pad it's showing;
- **the deck** (TURNTABLE) or the **bass lane** — loads it there;
- **the DISCOVER crate** — adds it (a folder adds its audio and video);
- **anywhere else** — a menu asks what to do with it: load it onto the selected pad, onto the next empty pad (several files: onto empty pads in order), send it to the deck, add it to the DISCOVER crate, or **match the project tempo to it** (sets the tempo from the file's detected BPM).

## The pad grid

16 pads. By default they're laid out bottom-left to top-right (pad 1 bottom-left, pad 16 top-right), matching how many hardware pad controllers number their physical pads — so the pad you see selected is the pad you actually hit. Click **Hardware Layout** in the toolbar to switch back to plain top-left-to-bottom-right reading order. Either way, the underlying MIDI note mapping is unchanged (notes 36–51 always trigger pads 1–16 in the same order) — this only affects which grid cell each pad's box is drawn in.

Each pad plays one sample, one-shot (it always plays from the start of its region; triggering it again while it's still playing cuts the previous hit and restarts — different pads never cut each other off, unless **Mono** mode is on — see The toolbar).

- **Chop lanes** (right-click a sliced pad > **Chop lanes...**) -- paint a value for each chop straight over the waveform. The window shows the sample the pad was sliced from, each chop as a column (with its pad number); pick a lane and drag across the columns. Letting go plays the last chop you painted.

| Lane | What a chop gets |
|---|---|
| **Volume** / **Pan** | Its level and place. |
| **Pitch** | Up or down, -12 to +12 semitones. |
| **Reverse** | Top half plays it backwards. |
| **Stutter** | Its start played 2, 3, 4, 6 or 8 times, in the chop's own length. |
| **Filter** | The cutoff (top = open), with the filter picked next to the lane: Low-Pass, Low-Pass 24, Band-Pass, High-Pass, Notch or Comb. |
| **Delay** / **Reverb** | How much goes to the shared delay (a dotted 1/8 at the tempo, bouncing left and right) or reverb. |

  **Random** fills the lane with musical values (pitch mostly on 0, 5, 7 and 12), **Repeat** copies the chops up to the last one you painted over the rest (paint 1-4, then Repeat), **Clear** puts the lane back to normal. Each stroke or button is one **Undo**.

  Each chop is a pad, so what you paint is that pad's own setting: it plays wherever the chop does -- hit, SEQ, the keyboard, exports -- and shows on the pad's own controls. (A lock on a SEQ step only changes that one step.) Stutter suits one-shots; a looping pad ignores it.

- **Drum synth** (right-click a pad > **Drum synth...**) -- make a drum from scratch instead of loading one: **Kick**, **808**, **Snare**, **Closed hat**, **Open hat**, **Clap**, **Rim**, **Tom** or **Cowbell**, shaped by five knobs:

| Knob | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Tune** | Up or down a semitone at a time (a kick at +12 is an octave higher). |
| **Decay** | How long it rings -- a tight hat or an open one, a short kick or a long 808. |
| **Tone** | Darker or brighter: the click on a kick, the sizzle on a snare or hat. |
| **Punch** | The attack: how far a kick's pitch drops, a snare's snap, how spread a clap's slaps are. |
| **Drive** | Saturation: louder, rounder, then gritty. |

  Every change plays the new drum. On an empty pad it starts with a kick; on a pad that already has a sound, the first change replaces it (one **Undo** brings the old sound back). The drum is saved as a WAV in **Music > Boom Bap Captures > Drum Synth**, so it plays like any sample -- in SEQ, with the crush and stretch modes, in exports and kit exports -- and opening **Drum synth...** again shows its knobs where you left them.

- **Drag a pad into your DAW.** Drag a loaded pad (without Shift) onto a track and its sound -- the trimmed region -- lands there as a WAV named after the pad ("Pad 3 - Kick.wav"), kept in **Music > Boom Bap Drag Out**. Shift+drag swaps two pads instead.
- **< and >: try the next sample.** Hover a loaded pad and arrows appear on its left and right edges. **>** loads the next sound in the same folder as the pad's sample, **<** the one before (in the order Explorer lists them, going round at the end). The pad keeps its settings -- pitch, filter, envelope, effects -- so you hear each kick through the same chain. If nothing is playing, the new sound plays once; while a beat plays, you hear it in the pattern instead. The same two are in the pad's right-click menu.
- **Key Pads** (next to Hardware Layout) — play the pads from your computer keyboard. The keys are laid out like the pads on screen:

| Hardware Layout on | Hardware Layout off |
|---|---|
| `1 2 3 4` = pads 13-16 | `1 2 3 4` = pads 1-4 |
| `Q W E R` = pads 9-12 | `Q W E R` = pads 5-8 |
| `A S D F` = pads 5-8 | `A S D F` = pads 9-12 |
| `Z X C V` = pads 1-4 | `Z X C V` = pads 13-16 |

  Hold **Shift** to play softer. On a bigger grid the keys cover the first 16 pads' corner of it. It works on every tab except TURNTABLE (whose letters chop the record), so you can play pads while you're on SEQ, KEYS, SYNTH and the rest. While Key Pads is on, **E** plays a pad instead of resizing the Sample Editor (use its Expand button), and typing in a text box still types. It's remembered for next time.

- **Keyboard and screen readers. Tab** moves through the controls; on a pad, **Space** or **Return** plays it and **Shift+F10** opens its menu. Screen readers (Narrator, NVDA) read each pad as "Pad 3: <its sample>", and each knob, fader and dropdown by its name ("Cutoff", "Pad 3 volume", "Grid size").
- **Click an empty pad** — opens a file chooser to load a sample onto it.
- **Click a loaded pad** — selects it (highlights gold) and triggers it (flashes, and glows orange while the sample is still playing).

- **Quick Stop** — a small stop icon appears in the top-left corner of any pad that's currently playing (it takes over the Choke Group letter badge's spot, which comes back once playback stops). Click it to cut the pad off right away instead of waiting for a long sample to finish.
- **Drag an audio file onto any pad** — loads it directly, from Windows Explorer or your DAW's own sample browser if it supports OS-level drag-and-drop.
- **Drag a loaded pad's sample out** (past a small threshold) — exports its current region to a temp WAV and starts a real file drag: drop it onto another pad to copy the sample there, or drop it into your DAW's own browser/playlist to pull it out of the plugin entirely.
- **Right-click any pad** — Load Sample… / Clear / Rename…, **Send to the deck** (to chop it again on the TURNTABLE tab, as it is or as it sounds -- see Chop a pad again), plus Choke Group, **Layers** (see below), Color, and three **Insert FX** submenus (Insert FX 1/2/3 — up to 3 effects in series on that pad). Each slot can hold Chorus, Flanger, Phaser, Transient Designer, Harmonic Exciter, Stereo Doubler, Reverb, Delay, one of 3 Saturation flavors (Tube, Transformer, Console), or Formant Shift, a **Shape Filter** (a filter that opens and shuts in time with the song along a shape you draw), or an **EQ** (with **Edit EQ...**, see the MIXER tab) ("None" is the default — sounds exactly like it always did). Reverb, Delay, Saturation, and Formant Shift slots also get an "Edit Knobs…" option in that same submenu for adjusting their parameters (Size/Damping/Mix, Time/Feedback/Mix, Drive, or Shift).
- **Key Shift Pad** (right-click menu, on a loaded pad) — spreads that pad's sample across your other empty pads, each one a semitone higher than the last. Turns one chop into a playable chromatic instrument across the grid, without needing the KEYS tab.
- **Layers** (right-click menu) — makes this pad play one of several pads each time it's hit. That's how you get drums that don't sound machine-gunned, and hits that change character with how hard you play. Load the variations onto pads next to each other, right-click the first one and pick:
  - **Velocity layers:** soft hits play the first pad, harder hits the next ones, the hardest hits the last one. Load them softest first.
  - **Round robin:** each hit plays the next pad in turn.
  - **Random:** each hit plays one of them at random, never the same one twice in a row.

  Then choose how many pads (this pad and up to 7 after it). If you've batch-selected pads (Ctrl+click), you can also build the group from those. The pad you right-clicked shows **VEL**, **RR** or **RND** and the count in its corner; the others show **in N** (the pad that plays them). They all stay normal pads with their own chop, envelope and effects, and you can still play or program them on their own. Program the pattern on the first pad and the variations happen by themselves, in the bounce too. **Off** undoes it. A pad can only be in one group.
- **Key zones** (right-click > Layers) -- several pads become **one instrument across the keyboard**. Each pad holds a note of the instrument (a piano's C3, C4, C5...), named in its file name ("Piano_C3.wav", "Rhodes F#4.wav"). Load them on pads side by side, right-click the first and pick **Key zones > Pads 1-4** (up to 16 pads). Then select that first pad and play the keyboard, the KEYS piano roll or MIDI channel 2: every note plays the nearest recorded note, tuned from there -- so a C sounds like the C sample and an F like the nearest one, not one sample stretched across five octaves. The pad shows **KEYS**. If a pad's file has no note in its name, it says which.
  - Quickest way in: **Kit... > Import > Folder as one instrument** puts a whole folder of named notes onto empty pads and sets this up for you.
  - The SYNTH tab's **To Pads... > One per octave** makes one too.
  - Notes in names count middle C as **C4** (60). A pack that calls it C3 just sits an octave higher -- play it an octave down.

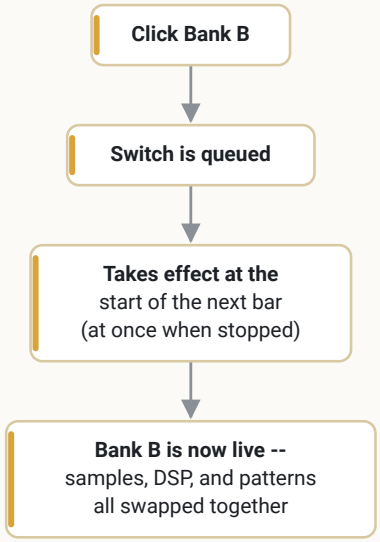
- **Blend the layers (morph)** (right-click > Layers, on a Velocity layers or Key zones pad) -- instead of jumping from one layer to the next, the layers **crossfade**: in between two of them you hear both, mixed so the level stays even. The pad's corner tag gets a **~**. Pick what moves the blend:
  - **Blend by velocity** -- how hard you hit sets the mix: soft hits the first pad, hard hits the last, and everything in between a smooth mix of the two nearest. No more sudden jump at a velocity boundary.
  - **Blend by the mod wheel (CC1)** or **by expression (CC11)** -- the mix moves **while the note holds**: push the wheel up and a held string or horn note grows from soft to loud. Wheel down plays the first pad, up the last; expression starts at full.
  - **Blend by an LFO** -- the mix sweeps back and forth by itself from each hit. **Mix / centre** sets where it sweeps around, **LFO rate** how fast (0.25-8 Hz) and **LFO depth** how far.
  - **Blend at a fixed mix** -- two sounds stacked at the **Mix** you pick (0% the first, 100% the last): a kick with a little of another kick's click, two drum-synth pads blended into one.
  - **Switch (no blend)** goes back to plain layers.

  In **key zones**, pads whose files are on the **same note** become that note's soft-to-loud layers (load "Strings_C4_soft" and "Strings_C4_loud" and give both C4): the blend crossfades between them. A note with just one sample gets a level instead -- the wheel takes it from quiet (-18 dB) up to full. Export WAV plays the blend as it sounds live (the wheel and expression stay where they are when you export). The blend is saved with the project and the kit.

- **Favorite** (right-click menu) — protects this pad's step pattern from Randomize and Flip the Sample (see Step sequencer) — shown with a small gold star.
- Supported file types: `.wav`, `.aif`/`.aiff`, `.flac`, `.ogg`, `.mp3`, `.m4a`/`.aac`, `.wma` — and videos (`.mp4`, `.mov`, `.mkv`, `.avi`, `.wmv`, `.webm`, `.m4v`, `.3gp`, `.mpg`), which load their soundtrack. See DISCOVER → using videos for what Windows can decode and the 20-minute limit.

Pads also respond to MIDI: notes 36–51 (C1 upward) trigger pads 1–16 with real velocity sensitivity from your MIDI controller/keyboard. Clicking a pad in the UI always triggers at a fixed velocity.

**Bank A / B / C / D** buttons (right under the grid, next to "Editing pad N" — also available on the SEQ tab) switch between 4 complete kits — 4 banks x 16 pads = 64 addressable pad slots in total. Switching banks swaps *everything*: every pad's sample, every DSP setting, and every pattern, all together, so each bank is a genuinely separate kit rather than just an alternate pattern for the same 16 samples. A bank switch is bar-quantized — while the song is playing it takes effect at the start of the next bar, not the instant you click, so it never chops a pattern off mid-phrase. While it's stopped, it switches straight away.




**Grid size** dropdown (next to the Bank buttons) — each bank can be its own size: 4x4 (16 pads, the default), 5x5 (25), 6x6 (36), 7x7 (49), or 8x8 (64). Picking a bigger size adds more pads to the grid immediately — the pads themselves get smaller to fit the same space, the plugin window doesn't grow. This applies to whichever bank is currently active and takes effect right away, unlike Bank switching itself (no bar-quantize wait — there's no audio content to keep in sync, just how many pads are addressable). Every other bank keeps its own independently-set size, so Bank A can stay a compact 4x4 while Bank B runs a full 8x8. The SEQ/KEYS/DISCOVER tabs and MIDI note range all follow whichever size the active bank is currently set to; see Output routing for the one thing that's capped at 16 regardless of grid size.

**Kit...** (just left of the Grid size dropdown) exports the active bank as a SoundFont, SFZ, DecentSampler preset, sliced WAV or a whole FL Studio pack, and imports kits from those formats or a folder of samples. See Kit import & export.

CHAPTER 06

# Kit import and export

The **Kit...** button on the PADS tab (just left of the grid size, under the pads) moves a whole bank's kit in and out of the plugin: take your kit into FL Studio, another sampler or a DAW, or bring a kit made elsewhere in, with each sound on its own pad.

Everything works on the **bank you're looking at** (A, B, C or D).

## Export kit

Every loaded pad goes out exactly as it plays: trimmed to its region, reversed if Reverse is on, at its Normalize level. Pad 1 is always MIDI note 36, pad 2 is 37, and so on.

| Choose | You get | Load it in |
|---|---|---|
| **SoundFont (.sf2)** | One file with every pad on its own key | DirectWave, FL Studio's Fruity SoundFont Player, Kontakt, most samplers |
| **SFZ** | `Kit.sfz` plus one WAV per pad, in a new folder | Any SFZ player (sforzando, TX16Wx, Sitala...) |
| **DecentSampler preset** | A `.dspreset` and a `Samples` folder, in a new folder | DecentSampler (free) |
| **Sliced WAV with markers** | Every pad back to back in one WAV, with a slice marker at the start of each | FL Studio's Slicex or Fruity Slicer - each pad becomes a slice |
| **FL Studio pack** | A folder with all of it: `One-shots` (a WAV per pad, ready for FPC), the SoundFont, the sliced WAV, the bank's pattern as MIDI, and a short how-to | FL Studio |

What carries over: volume, pan, tuning (Tune, Fine and Speed), the envelope (attack, decay, sustain, release), choke groups, and Loop. The SFZ export also keeps Reverse, Loop and **Play To End** as settings.

**Layers** (a pad's right-click **Layers** groups) carry over too: the group's sounds all go on the first pad's key. SFZ and DecentSampler keep velocity layers, round robin and random. SoundFonts can only split by velocity, so a round-robin or random group goes out as each pad on its own key. Filter, bitcrush and insert effects stay in this plugin - these formats have nothing to hold them.

Exports never overwrite: a folder that already exists gets a number, like `Boom Bap Kit A (SFZ) (2)`. The message afterwards has a **Show in Explorer** button.

### Why not FPC, DirectWave or Kontakt files directly?

Those programs save their own kits in private formats that aren't published (Kontakt's are encrypted), so no other program can write them reliably. But every one of them **opens** the formats above: FPC takes the one-shot WAVs, DirectWave and Kontakt load the SoundFont, Slicex loads the sliced WAV.

## Import kit

Import **replaces the pads of the bank you're looking at**: the bank is cleared, each pad is reset to its default settings, and the kit's sounds go on. **Undo** puts the previous kit back, settings and all.

| Choose | What happens |
|---|---|
| **SoundFont (.sf2)** | Every sound in the SoundFont's first preset gets a pad. The sounds are saved as WAV files in `Documents\Boom Bap Producer Pads\Imported Kits` (pads always play from a file). |
| **SFZ** | Every region gets a pad, with its volume, pan, tuning, envelope, choke group, reverse and loop. |
| **DecentSampler preset** | Every sample gets a pad, with the same settings, and the group's name as the pad's name. |
| **WAV with slice markers** | Each slice becomes a pad playing that part of the file - a WAV saved by FL Studio's Edison, one exported from here, or any WAV with markers. |
| **Folder of samples** | Every audio file in the folder, in name order ( `2 Snare` before `10 Clap` ). Subfolders aren't included. |
| **Folder as one instrument** | A folder of one instrument's notes, each named with its note ( `Piano_C3.wav` , `Piano_F#3.wav` ...), goes onto empty pads as **key zones**: the first pad plays the whole instrument across the keyboard, each note from the nearest sample (see Key zones). Up to 16 notes -- with more, an even spread from the lowest to the highest is kept. Where a note has several files (velocity or round-robin takes), the first by name is used. |

Where each sound lands:

- A sound mapped to **one key** goes on that key's pad (key 36 = pad 1). That's how drum kits line up with the right pads.
- Sounds that cover **a range of keys** (a multisampled piano or strings) fill the empty pads from the lowest range to the highest.
- If there are more sounds than pads, the rest are skipped and the message says how many. Pick a bigger **Grid Size** (up to 8x8) and import again.

Good to know:

- A SoundFont with several presets (a whole General MIDI set) imports only the first one.
- **Velocity layers and round robin come in as Layers.** Samples that share a key in the kit each get a pad, and the pad on that key plays them as a group: by velocity, in turn, or at random, as the kit says (see Layers). Samples that share a key but play *together* in the source (a stack) just get their own pads.
- SoundFonts have no "play to the end" setting, so a Play To End pad exported to SF2 comes back with a release as long as the sound, which plays the same way.
- Some commercial libraries encrypt their samples. Those can't be read, and the message names a missing sample so you can tell.

CHAPTER 07

# The Sample Editor

Top-right panel of the PADS tab — shows the waveform of whichever pad is currently selected.




*The Sample Editor, expanded*

- **Expand** / **Full Screen** — make the waveform bigger: Expand takes over the sound controls' space, Full Screen the whole tab. **E** steps through Normal, Expanded and Full Screen; **Escape** goes back to Normal.
- **Trim handles** (the two vertical orange bars) — drag to set the region the pad actually plays. Everything outside the region is dimmed.
- **Click inside the waveform** — drops a cyan cut-point marker.
- **Chop** — splits the current region at every cut-point marker you've placed, and assigns the resulting slices to this pad and the pads after it (up to the last pad of the grid — slices never wrap back around).
- **Clear Cuts** — removes any pending cut-point markers without chopping.

## Slice

The row under Chop cuts the region for you. Pick a **mode**, set its amount with the slider, and press **Slice**: slice 1 stays on this pad, the rest go on the pads after it. **Undo** puts it back.

| Mode | The slider sets | What it does |
|---|---|---|
| **Equal** | how many slices (2-64) | Cuts the region into equal pieces. |
| **Transients** | sensitivity | Cuts at every hit. Low sensitivity keeps only the big hits (kick, snare); high catches the quiet ones too (ghost notes, hats). |
| **Beat grid** | slice length: 1 bar, 1/2 bar, 1 beat, 1/8, 1/16 | Cuts on the beat, from the sample's detected tempo, lined up with its first hit. Each line settles onto a hit that's close by, so a played loop still cuts on its real hits. |
| **Find chops** | how many chops (2-32) | Picks strong hits that start a phrase (on the beat, especially the one) and makes a chop from each to the next, at most two bars long. The quick way to pull the best parts out of a loop. |
| **Random** | how many slices | Cuts at random points (nudged onto nearby hits). Press again for a different set. |

- If there are more slices than pads left, the rest are skipped and a message by the Slice button says how many. Pick a bigger Grid Size, or slice from an earlier pad.
- **Beat grid** needs a tempo. If none was detected in the sample, it estimates one from the region, and failing that uses your project's tempo (the message says so).
- Cuts are placed a hair before each hit so the attack is never shaved off, and every slice fades in and out over a millisecond or so at the points where it was cut — no clicks, even cutting through a held note. A pad playing a whole sample keeps its instant attack.
- To reverse one slice, select its pad and turn on **Reverse** in the sound controls — each slice is its own pad.
- **More** has two extras:
  - **Slice into the next empty bank:** the same slices, but onto pads 1 onward of the next bank that has no sounds and no pattern. The plugin switches to that bank, and your current kit isn't touched. While the song is playing, the switch (and the slices) happen at the start of the next bar. Undo takes the slices back.
  - **Save slices as MIDI...:** saves this pad's slices as a MIDI file that plays them in their original order and timing. Drag it into your DAW and the loop plays back from the pads, ready to rearrange. Or skip the dialog: drag the small dotted grip beside **More** straight onto a track.
- **Quantize** toggle — when on, placing a cut point or dragging a trim handle snaps to the nearest beat-grid line (shown as faint vertical lines once a tempo is detected) instead of the exact pixel you clicked. With no detected tempo, it snaps to the nearest transient instead.
- **Trim Silence** — trims leading and trailing silence (below roughly -48dBFS) from the current region automatically. Only scans within the region you've already set, so running it again after a manual trim narrows further rather than re-scanning material you already cut away.
- **BPM / Key** readout — automatically detected when you load a sample (shows `--` for either if nothing could be estimated — a one-shot hit with no discernible tempo, for example). **Sync** sets this pad's Speed so its detected BPM matches your host's current tempo, one click.
- **Freq** toggle — switches the waveform from the plain gold colour to a tint by frequency content (bass-heavy = red, treble-heavy = blue), so you can spot where the low end and the brighter transients sit at a glance.
- **Zoom slider** — 0 (fully zoomed out) to fully zoomed in.
- **Ctrl+scroll** on the waveform — zooms in/out anchored to wherever your cursor is, like a code editor. Plain scroll (no ctrl) pans left/right once you're zoomed in.

## Recording into a pad

**Rec** (bottom left of the Sample Editor) records your audio input straight onto the selected pad: a vocal, a guitar, a record playing on a real turntable, anything coming into your computer.

1. **Turn the input on** (once):
   - **Standalone:** choose your microphone or audio interface as the input in the audio settings. If there's no input yet, Rec offers to open them; you can also right-click Rec. The little meter beside Rec moves when sound is coming in.
   - **In a DAW:** send a track, or your interface's input, to Boom Bap Producer Pads' **sidechain input**. Every DAW does this a little differently; look for "sidechain" in the plugin's routing. The input stays off until you do, so nothing changes for projects that don't use it.
2. **Press Rec.** It says *Waiting for sound...* and starts recording the moment sound comes in, keeping a few milliseconds from just before so the attack isn't cut off. Right-click Rec and pick **Start straight away** to record from the moment you press it instead.
3. **Press Stop** when you're done (or **Cancel** while it's still waiting). Recordings stop by themselves after 2 minutes.

The take is saved as a WAV in your **Music\Boom Bap Recordings** folder (named after the pad and the time) and loaded onto the pad it was armed on, so your project, presets and kits keep it like any other sample. Right-click Rec → **Open the recordings folder** to find them. What's coming in is never played through the plugin, so you won't hear it twice (or get feedback) while recording.

## Grab: the last few seconds, onto a pad

**Grab** (next to Rec) is always listening. Press it and the last 30 seconds -- of whatever the plugin has been playing -- go onto the selected pad, the quiet bits at either end trimmed off. Nothing to arm, nothing to miss: play around until something sounds good, then Grab it.

- It's **resampling** in one click: jam a beat, Grab it, chop it on the pad or send it to the deck (pad menu), and build on it.
- **Right-click Grab** for the length (the last **10**, **20** or **30** seconds), what it keeps -- **what's playing** (the default) or **the audio input** (set up as for Rec, above) -- and **Open the captures folder**.
- Grabs are saved as WAVs in **Music\Boom Bap Captures** and loaded onto the pad like any sample, so your project keeps them.
- Switching what it keeps starts the listening afresh.
- **Straight into your DAW:** drag the small dotted grip beside Grab onto a track. The last seconds are saved to the captures folder the same way and dropped in your DAW, without touching any pad.

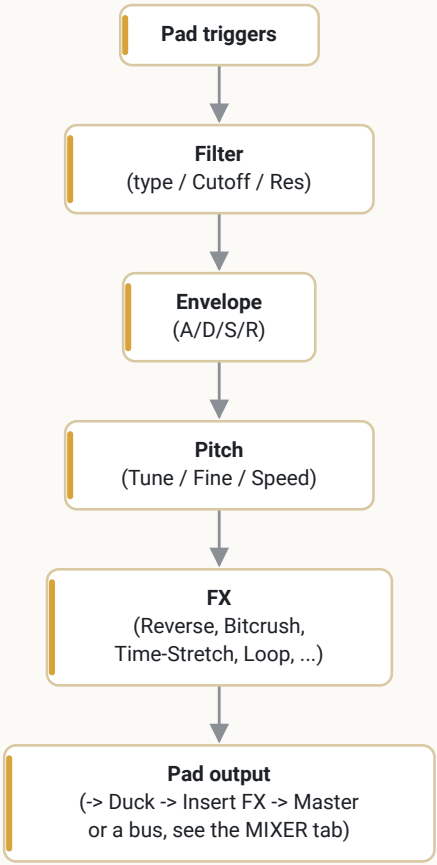
CHAPTER 08

# A pad's sound controls

Below the sample editor on the PADS tab — the same per-pad chain, always following whichever pad is selected. Every knob/toggle on the Sound page is a real, host-automatable parameter and supports MIDI Learn. Scrolling over any knob nudges its value by a small, precise step.




*The pad's sound controls*




The buttons along the top of the panel pick what it shows: **Sound** (the controls below), **Mod** (the Mod page: LFO, pitch envelope, velocity response, loop shaping and Voices) or **Grain** (the Grain page: granular mode). When a pad is in granular mode its button reads **Grain ***, so you can tell from any page.

**Faders** (top of the panel) switches every knob on the Sound page to a vertical fader instead — same controls, same values, same MIDI Learn bindings, just a different shape (bottom-to-top strips instead of dials), if that's a layout you find quicker to read or automate by ear. **Expand** grows this panel by temporarily shrinking the sample editor above it, for more room to work the strips precisely. Both are purely visual — nothing about the sound or the underlying parameters changes.

- **Filter** — a type picker, Cutoff (20 Hz–20 kHz) and Res(onance) (0.1–10), reset fresh on every trigger. The types:
  - **Low-Pass** (the default) keeps the lows and removes the highs: turn Cutoff down to make a sound darker or more muffled.
  - **High-Pass** removes the lows: thin out a sample so it sits above the kick and bass.
  - **Band-Pass** keeps a band around Cutoff: the "telephone" or "radio" sound. Res makes the band narrower.
  - **Notch** removes a narrow band around Cutoff and keeps the rest.

  Switching away from Low-Pass while Cutoff is fully open (20 kHz) moves Cutoff somewhere audible for you (200 Hz for High-Pass, 1 kHz for the others), since a fully open high-pass would be silent.
- **Envelope** — Attack, Decay, Sustain, Release (0–5 seconds, Sustain is a 0–1 level). This is position-based, not held-note-based: since pads are one-shot, Attack/Decay ramp in from the start of the region and Release

ramps out over the last R seconds *before* the region's natural end.

- **Pitch** — Tune (±24 semitones), Fine (±100 cents), Speed (0.5x–2.0x). By default Speed is a simple resample-based stretch, so it changes pitch too — turn on **Time-Stretch** (in the FX row) to decouple them: Speed then changes duration only, while Tune/Fine keep controlling pitch on their own. Time-Stretch runs in the background and takes a moment to catch up after you change Speed or first turn it on — playback keeps working normally with the old behavior in the meantime. The menu beside Time-Stretch picks **how** it stretches:

| Stretch mode | What it sounds like |
|---|---|
| **Clean** | Smooth joins -- the stretch tries not to be heard. |
| **Tight** | Old samplers' stretch: short slices repeated or skipped, joined as they fall. A light warble; drums stay punchy. |
| **Loose** | Longer slices: an audible stutter and wobble, good on chords and loops. |
| **Buzz** | Very short slices: a robotic buzz on voices and sustained notes -- the classic jungle stretch. Push Speed further for more. |

Tight, Loose and Buzz are the vintage modes; picking one turns Time-Stretch on. They leave the pitch where it was to within a few hertz (that small drift is the warble). Time-Stretch and its mode are kept with the project, the pad's bank and a saved kit. **Key Snap** (in the FX row) rounds Tune to notes that are actually in the project's key (KEYS > Key and Scale) -- or, with the scale on None, the pad's detected key -- instead of any raw semitone; the pad's detected key needs to have been detected first (see the BPM/Key readout in the sample editor).

- **FX** — Reverse (plays the region backward), Bitcrush (Bits: 2–16, Rate Div: 1–32, a sample-rate-reduction/decimation effect for lo-fi grit -- see **Crush modes** below), Time-Stretch and Key Snap (see Pitch above), **Loop** (repeats the region instead of stopping — best used with a held MIDI note or the on-screen keyboard, since releasing the note is what stops it), and **Play To End** (ignores note-off, always plays the full region regardless of how short the trigger was).
- **Crush modes** -- the menu beside Bits and Rate Div. Old samplers sounded the way they did for more than their bit depth: each ran at its own sample rate, and some filtered the sound before sampling it (warm, dark) while others didn't (sharp highs folding down into strange ringing tones -- the "dirty" sound). Each mode is one of those converters, with its own rate, bits and filters:

| Mode | What it does to the sound |
|---|---|
| **Raw** | The Bits and Rate Div knobs, as before. |
| **Gritty 12-bit** | 26 kHz with no filter going in: highs fold down into grit. The classic dusty drum sound. |
| **Warm 12-bit** | 40 kHz, filtered going in and out: round, a little dark, no harshness. |
| **Crunchy 8-bit** | 22 kHz, fewer steps and folding highs: crunchy, buzzy. |
| **Lo-fi 8-bit** | 11 kHz: dull and small, like an old radio or a games console. |
| **Soft 16-bit** | 32 kHz: clean, with the top end gently rolled off. |

Picking a mode turns Bitcrush on, and greys out Bits and Rate Div (the mode sets them). It works the same at any project sample rate, plays the same in Export WAV, goes with the pad when you swap two pads, and is a "Pad N Crush Mode" parameter your DAW can automate.

- **Normalize** — scans the pad's current region and boosts it so its peak hits 0dBFS. **Reset** removes that boost. Non-destructive; recomputed automatically if you re-chop or re-trim.

## The Mod page

Press **Mod** at the top of the panel. These controls make a pad's sound move and respond to how hard you play. Like everything else in this panel they follow the selected pad, and they're saved with your project, in bank kits and in presets. They're also copied by A/B compare and apply to every batch-selected pad. Unlike the Sound page, they aren't DAW parameters, so they can't be automated or MIDI-learned -- except the LFO's **Depth** (see below). **Reset Mod** turns all of them back off for the pad (the filter type and Voices stay).

- **LFO**: a slow wobble. Pick what it moves:
  - **Pitch** for vibrato. Low Depth is a gentle vibrato; high Depth is a siren, up to an octave either way.
  - **Filter** for a "wah" sweep, up to 4 octaves either way around Cutoff.
  - **Volume** for tremolo. Full Depth dips all the way to silence.
  - **Pan** to swing the sound left and right.

  **Shape** sets how it moves: Sine (smooth), Triangle, Square (on/off, softened so it doesn't click), Saw Down, or Random (a new level each cycle). **Rate** is in cycles per second. Turn on **Sync** to lock it to the tempo instead, from once a bar down to every 1/16 note. The LFO starts from the beginning on every hit, so a pad sounds the same each time you play it (Random included).

  **Depth can be automated in your DAW.** Each pad has a parameter called **Pad N LFO Depth** (Pad 1 LFO Depth, Pad 2 LFO Depth...): draw automation for it to open a filter sweep over a build-up, or bring in vibrato on the last bar. The Depth knob follows the automation while it plays. It's also saved with the pad everywhere the other Mod settings are.

- **Shape**: a movement you draw, as a second LFO, a step pattern or an envelope. Pick what it moves (**Pitch**, **Filter**, **Volume** or **Pan**), how far (minus turns it upside down), and press **Draw...**: click to add points, drag them, drag a line to bend it, or switch to steps; set its length (1/16 to 4 bars, in time with the song) and whether it **loops** or plays once from each hit and holds its end. A volume shape in eighths is an instant chop; a pitch shape that drops once is a tape stop.
- **Pitch Envelope**: **Amount** bends the pitch at the moment of the hit (up to 24 semitones either way), and it glides back to the pad's own pitch over the **Glide** time. A positive Amount with a short Glide (50-150 ms) gives a kick or tom a punchy "thump"; a long Glide gives a tape-start or riser feel.
- **Velocity**: how the pad responds to how hard you hit it. **Filter** makes softer hits darker, up to 4 octaves of Cutoff at the softest. **Start** makes softer hits start later into the sound (up to 50 ms), skipping some of the attack. Both do nothing on full-velocity hits.
- **Loop** (needs **Loop** turned on on the Sound page): **Ping-Pong** plays the loop forward, then backward, then forward again. **X-Fade** (up to 500 ms) smooths the loop point: the end of the loop fades into its start, so a loop chopped at an awkward spot doesn't click or thump each time round. X-Fade works on forward loops (not Reverse or Ping-Pong).
- **Voices**: how many hits of this pad can sound at once.
  - **1 - cut** (the default): a new hit stops the one before it, with a tiny fade so it doesn't click.

  - **2 to 8**: earlier hits keep ringing underneath the new one. Use this for long cymbals or 808s that shouldn't choke themselves, rolls that overlap, or playing chords on the KEYS tab from one pad. When a pad runs out of voices, its oldest hit fades out.

  Choke groups, Mono mode and the stop button still cut every voice. The pad shows as playing while any of its hits still sounds.

- **Release**: a pad that plays when you **let go** of a note on this one -- the thump of a piano key coming up, a string's release, a breath at the end of a vocal note. Load that sound on another pad and pick it here. The menu beside it says how it fades: the longer the note was held, the quieter the release (half as loud every 0.5, 1, 2 or 4 seconds, or **No fade**), and it follows how hard the note was hit.
  - It plays when a note **ends**: notes from your DAW's piano roll or a MIDI controller, the on-screen keyboard, and SEQ steps given a **length** (the note is let go where the length runs out). A step with no length just plays its sample out, so there's no release. Export WAV plays the releases too.
  - With **key zones**, give each zone pad its own release, or just the zones you want.
- **Follow**: this pad's **Volume** or **Filter** moves with another sound's level -- another pad, the bass, the synth or a deck.
  - **Volume, +**: the pad only comes through while the other sound plays -- a gate. Put a long pad or a noise riser on it and follow the kick for a chopped, pumping texture.
  - **Volume, -**: the pad dips while the other sound plays -- a duck (like Duck on the MIXER, but from any one sound).
  - **Filter, +**: the filter opens as the other sound gets louder -- hats that brighten with the bass. **-** closes it. Up to four octaves.
  - It reacts within a few milliseconds and isn't in **Export WAV** (an export renders each pad on its own, without the others to listen to).
- **Vary**: every hit comes out a little different, so a hat played on every 16th or a snare roll doesn't sound like a machine gun. Four thin sliders, each 0 (off) by default -- drag one, double-click to reset:
  - **st** -- random pitch, each hit up to this many semitones higher or lower. 0.1-0.3 is a live drummer; a whole semitone is a wobbly tape.
  - **% pan** -- each hit up to this far left or right of the pad's Pan.
  - **oct** -- the filter cutoff, each hit up to this many octaves higher or lower (hear it with the cutoff below fully open).
  - **ms** -- each hit starts up to this much later into the sound, softening or blurring the attack.

  It isn't truly random each time: the 1st hit of a pad after you press Play always gets the same change, the 2nd hit its own, and so on. So a beat sounds the same every time you play it from the start, and **Export WAV** sounds exactly like it. (A pad hit live while the beat plays counts as one of its hits too.) With **Layers**, the hit's change is shared by the layer that plays -- and in a blend by every layer, so they stay in tune with each other.

## The Grain page

Press **Grain** at the top of the panel and turn on **Granular**. Instead of playing its sample from start to end, the pad now plays a *cloud* of tiny overlapping pieces of it ("grains"), each a few milliseconds to half a second long and faded in and out. Use it to turn a vocal, a chord or a sustained note into a pad, a texture or a drone, or to freeze a single moment of a sound and hold it.

Like the Mod page, these settings follow the selected pad, are saved with your project, in bank kits and presets, and are copied by A/B compare and batch selection. They aren't DAW parameters. **Reset Grain** puts the knobs (and the shape) back to their defaults and leaves Granular on or off.

**Shape** (beside the Granular switch) sets how each grain rises and falls:

- **Smooth** (the default): fades in and out -- soft, blended clouds.
- **Flat**: full level between short fades, so each grain keeps more of the sample's own attack and body.
- **Sharp**: starts at once and dies away, like a plucked or struck note -- rhythmic, glitchy clouds, especially at low Density.
- **Swell**: the reverse: rises and stops -- a backwards, breathing texture.

The level stays about the same whichever shape you pick.

- **Cloud**
  - **Size**: how long each grain is (10-500 ms). Short grains sound buzzy and blurred; long grains sound more like the sample itself.
  - **Density**: how many grains start each second (1-100). Low is sparse and stuttery, high is a smooth wash. The level stays about the same as you turn it up.
  - **Position**: where in the sample the cloud starts, from 0% (the start) to 100% (the end). With Reverse on, it counts from the end.
  - **Scan**: how fast the cloud moves through the sample. **100%** moves at the sample's own speed, **50%** at half speed (a slow stretch), **0** *freezes* it on one moment, and below 0 moves backward. Double-click the knob to go back to 0. When the cloud reaches the end of the sample it carries on from the start.
- **Spread**
  - **Jitter**: scatters each grain's start a little around the cloud's position, so the cloud sounds less mechanical. High Jitter mixes moments from all over the sample.
  - **Pitch**: each grain plays up to this many semitones above or below the pad's pitch, at random. A few semitones gives a chorus-like shimmer; 12 gives a cloud of notes.
  - **Stereo**: how far grains spread left and right.

How long a granular hit lasts: as long as the pad would normally play (its region at its pitch and speed), with the Sound page's envelope shaping it. For a sound that keeps going for as long as you hold the note, turn on **Loop** on the Sound page. The pad's Tune, Fine and Speed set the grains' pitch, and its filter, envelope, LFO and FX all still apply. A pitch LFO or the Pitch Envelope bends every sounding grain as it plays, so vibrato and pitch drops work on a cloud the way they do on the plain sample. Granular mode also sounds the same in **Export WAV** and **Export Full Song**. It replaces the loop shaping options (Ping-Pong and X-Fade) while it's on.

## Output routing

Pads 1-16 each have their own dedicated stereo output pair, so you can send an individual pad to its own channel in your DAW's mixer instead of the shared master output — useful for processing the kick separately from the rest of the kit, for example. This is off by default; enable it from your DAW's own multi-output routing UI for this plugin instance (exactly how varies by DAW — look for "add output" or similar on the plugin's mixer channel). Once a pad's own output is enabled, that pad's audio goes *only* to its own channel, not also into the main mix.

If a bank's grid size is set larger than 4x4, pads 17 and up always play through the main mix — dedicated per-pad outputs are capped at 16 regardless of grid size, since a real stereo output bus per pad adds up fast on the host side (tested up to a noticeable routing-dialog slowdown well before 64).

CHAPTER 09

# SEQ: the step sequencer




*The SEQ tab*

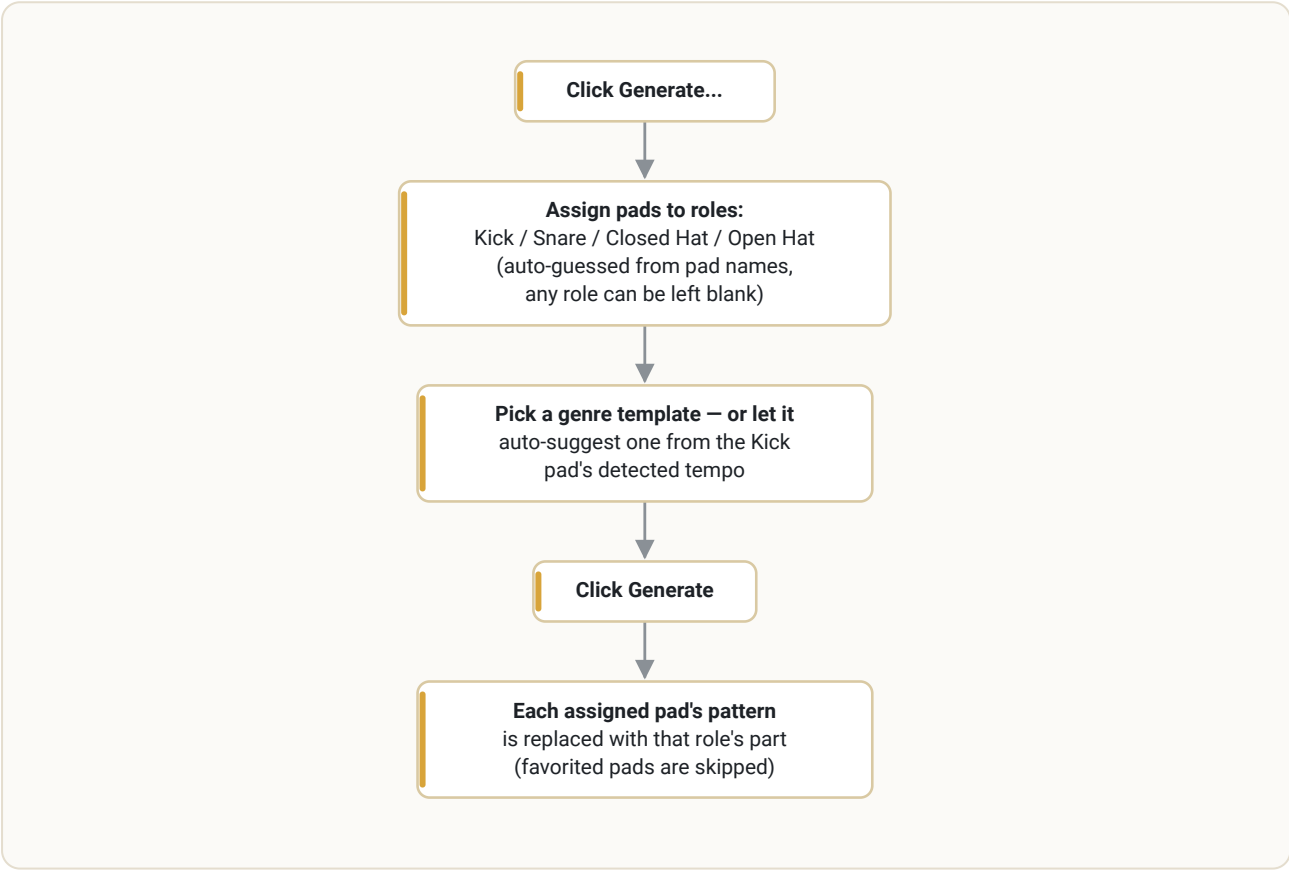
## Step sequencer

SEQ tab. The whole beat in one grid: a row for every pad in the active bank (its number and name on the left), across the 16 steps of one bar of 4/4, grouped by beat in shaded blocks of 4.

- **Click a pad's name** to select that pad. The tools that work on one pad (Copy / Paste, Humanize, Randomize, Clear Pattern, Nudge) use the selected pad; it's the same selection as on the PADS tab.
- **Click a step** on any row to toggle it on/off.
- **Scroll on a lit step** to adjust its velocity; **Shift+scroll** to adjust its trigger probability (shown as a % on the step once it's below 100 — a step at less than 100% has a chance of skipping each time round, for evolving/generative patterns).
- **Copy / Paste** — copy the selected pad's whole pattern (steps, pitch, length, velocity, probability) and paste it onto another pad.
- **Humanize** nudges the velocity and timing of already-lit steps a little, for a less mechanical feel. **Randomize** regenerates which steps are on/off at roughly the same density as before — the two compose (Randomize first, then Humanize the result, or either alone). **Flip** generates a fresh pattern across every pad that's a slice of the same chop as the selected pad — a quick way to hear a chopped loop rearranged. Right-click a pad and

choose **Favorite** to protect its pattern from both Randomize and Flip — a favorited pad (shown with a small gold star) keeps its pattern exactly while everything else changes around it, so you can lock in a part you like and keep regenerating the rest.

- **Shift-click Randomize** to keep the steps on the beat (1, 2, 3, 4) and redraw only the ones between.
- **Generate...** builds a whole drum pattern across several pads at once from a genre template — different from Randomize/Flip, which each work on one pad's existing pattern. 19 styles, from Boom Bap and Golden Era to Amapiano, Gqom, Kwaito and Baile Funk; besides Kick, Snare and the hats it can write a **Clap / Rim** and a **Perc** part. **Density** thins the pattern out (under 50) or fills it in (over 50) -- the kick on 1 and the backbeat always stay; **Complexity** adds ghost notes, a syncopated kick and hat rolls; **Variation** changes the later bars from the first; **Fill in the last bar** ends on a snare run. **Continue bar 1** keeps the first bar you made and carries it through the pattern's other bars, varied by Variation. Opens a small popup:




  - Roles left as **(none)** are skipped — you don't have to fill in all four, e.g. assign just Kick + Snare and leave the hats alone.
  - A pad named something like "Kick 1.wav" gets auto-selected for the Kick role (matched by name, e.g. "kick"/"bd", "snare"/"sd", and similar hints for the hats) — always changeable, never required.
  - 8 genre templates: Boom Bap, Trap, House, Dembow, Halftime, Afrobeats, Drill, Lo-Fi — each a different kick/snare/hat feel.
  - The Template dropdown auto-suggests whichever template best matches the Kick pad's detected tempo (closest match if none fits exactly) — a starting point, always changeable.
  - Generate **replaces** each assigned pad's whole pattern (not a merge) — same one-undo-snapshot safety net as Randomize/Flip, so Undo gets you back if you don't like the result.
  - Favorited pads are protected here too, same as Randomize/Flip.

- **Export WAV...** renders the current pattern (1-8 bars, the length beside it) to a WAV file, and **Export Full Song** the whole arrangement. Both are the whole mix as you hear it: the pads, the bass and the KEYS synth part, with their effects, sends, Duck and buses, and the master's effects, fader and limiter. A pattern's reverb and delay tails wrap round to its start, so the file loops cleanly; a song's ring out at the end.
- **Drag straight into your DAW.** The small dotted grips skip the save dialog: drag the one beside **Export WAV** for the beat as audio (as many bars as chosen), beside **Export Full Song** for the song (it renders first, so give it a moment), and beside **Export MIDI** for the pattern as MIDI. Drop it on a track. The file is named with the tempo and key ("Boom Bap Beat - 4 bars - 90 BPM - A Minor.wav"), so a DAW that reads tempos from names lines it up, and it's kept in **Music > Boom Bap Drag Out**, by date -- your DAW keeps pointing at it, so don't empty that folder while a song still uses something in it.
- **Export SFZ...** exports the current kit (every loaded pad's trimmed sample + volume/pan/tuning/ADSR/reverse, Play To End or Loop, and choke groups) as an SFZ instrument you can load in any SFZ-compatible sampler outside this plugin. More formats (SoundFont, DecentSampler, sliced WAV, an FL Studio pack) and kit import are on the PADS tab's **Kit...** button -- see Kit import & export.
- **Clear Pattern** wipes the selected pad's steps.
- **Swing** delays every second step slightly, for a less mechanical feel. It reads as a percent: 50% is straight, 67% a triplet feel. **Groove...** picks a named feel (Straight, Nudge, Lean, Shuffle, Triplet, Lazy, Drunk).
- **Volume** — persistent per-pad level, audible immediately even on a currently-playing pad (separate from the transient per-hit velocity).
- **Pad Quantize** (toolbar) — a *live-triggered* hit (real MIDI or a click) waits for the next beat instead of firing instantly; sequencer steps are unaffected, they're already on the grid. See The toolbar.
- The sequencer follows your DAW's transport and tempo — press play in your DAW, not in the plugin. (Running the plugin standalone, without a DAW, is different — see Saving your work & running standalone.)
- Whatever's actually playing here (and on the BASS lane) can also be sent out live as real MIDI, in addition to triggering this plugin's own audio — see the toolbar's MIDI Out toggle.

Each pad has its own row and its own pattern, so you build the whole beat in one view.

**Bank A / B / C / D** buttons switch between 4 complete kits — see The pad grid & sample browser for what a bank switch carries with it.

## Drum groove: accent, ratchet, flam, nudge and locks

The row under the SEQ buttons sets what a click on a step does -- **Edit**:

- **Steps** (the usual): a click turns a step on or off.
- **Accent**: a click makes the step louder (marked **A**), or back.
- **Ratchet**: each click plays the step 2 to 8 times inside its own 16th (marked **x2**-**x8**), then back to once -- rolls and stutters on hats and snares.
- **Flam**: a click adds a soft grace hit just before the step's hit (marked **f**), the way a drummer flams a snare.
- **Locks**: a click picks the step; then give that one step its own **Pan**, **Filter** cutoff and **Start** (how far into the slice it begins) -- marked *****. A hi-hat that opens up on the last step, a snare that hits from the middle of its sample, a kick panned for one hit. **Clear locks** puts the step back to the pad's own settings. A lock lasts until that pad's next hit; playing the pad live always uses its knobs. The same panel also has:
  - **Play** -- when the step plays (marked **?**). **1:2** is the 1st of every 2 times round its row, **2:4** the 2nd of every 4, and so on; **Fill** only while Fill is held; **First** only the first time round; **Prev** only when the row's last step with

a Play setting played. A **!** means the opposite. A kick on 2:2 plays every other bar.

- **Time** -- the step early (-) or late (+), up to half a step (marked **~**). Double-click it for on time.
- The ratchet's **Even** / **Ramp up** / **Ramp down**: its repeats get louder or softer.
- **Rev** -- the step plays its sample backwards (marked **R**).
- **Sticky** -- the step's locks stay on for the pad's next steps that have no locks of their own, until a step with its own locks.

### The lane, painting and the keys

The picker at the right of the Edit row opens a **lane** under the grid for the selected pad: **Velocity**, **Chance**, or one lock -- **Pan**, **Filter**, **Start**, **Time**, **Reso** (filter resonance), **Send** (its reverb send, live) or **Flam gap** (how far ahead a flam's grace hit is). Drag across it to draw a bar per lit step; right-click (or Alt-drag) clears a lock. A faint line means the step has no lock there.

- **Paint:** in Steps, press on a step and drag along the row -- every step you cross turns on (or off, if the first one was on).
- **Range:** the step you last clicked is outlined. Shift-click another on the same row (or shift + arrow keys) to pick the steps between. **Copy** then copies just those, and **Paste** puts them at the outlined step.
- **Keys** (after clicking a step): **Left / Right** move along the row, **Up / Down** to the next pad, **Space** or **Enter** clicks the step the way Edit says, **+ / -** changes its velocity, **Delete** turns it (or the range) off.

In any mode but Steps, clicking a step that's off turns it on with that change. The marks show on the steps (and the chance, if it's under 100%).

**Nudge pad N** (on the right when Edit isn't Locks): plays the selected pad a little late, up to half a 16th -- the laid-back snare that drags behind the beat. Each pad has its own; it's saved with the kit.

**Groove...** (beside Ghost...) takes the feel of a loop and puts it on your pattern. Take it from **this pattern**, from **the selected pad's sample** (a drum loop chopped onto a pad -- its hits are found for you, as 1 to 4 bars), or from **a MIDI file**; then **Apply** it to the selected pad or every pad at 25%, 50%, 75% or 100%. Each lit step moves that much toward the loop's timing and accent on that step (steps where the loop had no hit stay as they are). Undo takes it back. The groove is kept with the project.

Next to Nudge, **Swing: kit** gives the selected pad its own swing (kit = the PADS Swing) -- a straight hat over swung drums -- and **Swing steps / 8ths / 16ths / 32nds** picks what the swing moves: every second step, or the off 8ths, 16ths or 32nds.

Beside it, **< Shift** and **Shift >** move the selected pad's row a step earlier or later (what falls off one end comes round to the other), **Mirror** plays it last step first, and **Invert** turns its on steps off and its off steps on. They work over the row's own length; Undo takes them back.

All of it is saved with the pattern and its bank, copied by **Copy** / **Paste**, taken back by Undo, and heard the same in **Export WAV**.

## Longer patterns

A bank's pattern can be **1 to 4 bars**. The row above the grid:

- **Bars** sets the length. Going longer starts the new bars as copies of the ones you have; going shorter keeps the bars past the end (unheard), so going back brings them back.

- **Bar 1-4** shows that bar in the grid (the grid is always one bar). **Follow** shows whichever bar is playing.
- **Speed**: **Half time** plays every step as an 8th (the pattern lasts twice as long), **Double time** as a 32nd -- the same steps, nothing rewritten.
- **Hide empty** takes the pads with no steps out of the grid, so a big kit is easy to read. The selected pad always stays.
- **Meter**: 4/4, 3/4, 5/4, 6/8 or 7/8 -- how long a bar of this pattern is. Bank and pattern switches, ARRANGE sections, the count-in and Export WAV all count its bars (a 3/4 pattern switches every 3 beats). A pattern can be up to 64 steps, so 5/4 goes to 3 bars. The bass line and synth part stay in 4/4. In 4/4 the page buttons are bars; in other meters they show the steps (1-16, 17-32...).
- **Heat** colours the steps by velocity -- teal for soft, red for hard.
- **Row** gives the selected pad's row its own length (1-64 steps; **Pattern** = the pattern's). It loops on its own: a 3-step hat row against a 16-step pattern drifts and lines up again every 48 steps -- the classic polymeter. Each row shows its own playhead, and steps past a row's end are drawn dark (they don't play).
- The picker beside **Row** puts the row on its own grid: **1/16T** or **1/8T** (triplets) or **1/32**. Its steps then play on that grid -- the columns are its own steps, not the 16ths above them (a 1/16T row has 24 steps in a 16-step bar). Accent, ratchet, flam and locks work as usual.

Each bank keeps its own length and speed. A bank switch still happens on the next bar of the song, and the new bank starts at its own bar 1. Generate, Euclid, Chords and Melody write a bar and repeat it over the pattern; Randomize, Humanize and Flip work over the whole length.

## Pattern slots

Each bank holds **16 patterns** that share its kit -- the **Pattern** row:

- **1-16**: click one to play it. While the beat plays it waits for the next bar (**On beat**: the next beat) and shows a ***** until then; when stopped it switches at once. Lit buttons hold steps; gold is the one playing. Each pattern keeps its own Bars and Speed.
- **Duplicate** copies this pattern to the next empty slot and switches to it -- the quick way to start a variation.
- **Fill**: hold it and pattern 16 plays from the next bar; let go and the pattern you came from comes back. Keep your fill in 16.
- **Save... / Load...**: your pattern library (Documents > Boom Bap Producer Pads > Patterns). Load replaces the pattern you're on; Undo brings it back.
- **Bass** and **Synth part**: turn one on and the bass line (or the KEYS synth part) switches with the patterns too -- pattern 3 plays bass line 3. Turning it on copies the line you have into all 16, so nothing goes quiet; then change each one on its own. The numbers are shared by every bank.

Banks (**A**-**D**) are still whole kits; to chain patterns into a song, use the **ARRANGE** tab (right-click a section > **Pattern**).

## Roll / note-repeat

**Roll** toggle + rate dropdown (1/8, 1/16, 1/32), next to Clear Pattern. Turn it on, then press and hold any loaded pad — it auto-retriggers at the selected subdivision for as long as you hold it, free-running from your DAW's current tempo. Release to stop. While Roll is on, dragging a pad (the sample-export gesture on the pad grid) is disabled to avoid the two gestures colliding.

With Roll on, a pad held on a MIDI controller rolls too, at the velocity you hit it with -- and pressing harder (aftertouch) plays it louder.

**Roll...** (beside the rate):

- **Latch** -- the roll keeps going after you let go; press the same pad again to stop it (another pad takes it over).
- **Triplets** -- the rate in triplets (1/16 becomes 1/16T).
- **Swing** -- every second hit late by the Swing amount.
- **Velocity** -- even, or ramping up or down over a bar.

With Record armed, a roll is recorded into the pattern as ratchets on the steps it crosses (a 1/32 roll over 16th steps = x2 on each).

CHAPTER 10

# KEYS

KEYS has two editors -- pick one with the switch at the top left:

- **Synth part**: a part for the SYNTH tab's instrument -- chords and melodies, 1 to 8, 16 or 32 bars, looping with the transport. See the next section.
- **Pad melody**: the selected pad's own melody, one note per step (the rest of this page after the next section).

## Synth part




*KEYS: the synth part*

A piano roll for the synth. It plays whenever the transport plays (the Play button at the top, or your DAW), looping every 1-8, 16 or 32 bars.

- **Bars** sets how long it is; **Grid** is where notes land and how far they move: 1/4, 1/8, 1/16, 1/32, triplets (1/8T, 1/16T) or Off. **Width** spreads the beats out (then scroll sideways); **Zoom** (top right) makes the rows taller.
- **Draw**: click to add a note, the same length as the last one you made or set; drag right as you click to set its length. Stack notes on the same beat for **chords**. Drag a note to move it (hold **Alt** to copy), or drag its right edge to resize it. The same **Select** and **Erase** tools, **Key**, **Scale** and **Snap to scale** work here too.
- **Double-click** or **right-click** a note to remove it.

- **Keys**: **Delete**, **Up/Down** (transpose; **Shift**: an octave), **Left/Right** (a grid step), **Ctrl+A**, **Ctrl+D** (a copy of the selection straight after it), **Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y** (undo, redo -- or the **Undo** and **Redo** buttons), **Esc**.
- **Quantize** moves the selected notes (or all of them) onto the grid. **Clear** removes every note.
- **Chords...** writes a chord progression into the part: root, scale, progression, rhythm (one chord a bar, two a bar, or stabs on every beat), octave, and sevenths if you want them. It opens in the KEYS key.
- The keyboard on the left plays the synth; the lane underneath sets velocity (drag the bars); the bottom row shows and changes the selected notes' note, length (in 16th steps), velocity and chance -- and when they play: **Always**, **1:2** (the 1st of every 2 times round the part), **2:4**, **Fill**, **First**, **Prev** and their opposites (**!**).
- **Recording:** with **Record** armed and the beat playing, notes you play on the synth's MIDI channel go into the part where you played them (pulled to the 16ths by **Rec... > Quantize strength**).
- **Humanize** moves the selected notes (or all of them) a little early or late and a little louder or softer.
- **Stamp...** shows your key's seven chords as buttons (named as they'll sound). Pick a size and a length, then click chords in order: each one goes in after the last, so a few clicks write a progression. When the part is full the next one goes back to the start.
- The **chord lane**, under the bar numbers, shows each chord of the synth part as a named block lasting until the next one. Click a block to select that chord's notes (shift-click adds), then use Voicing... on it.
- Each chord in the synth part is **named** just above its top note -- C, Am7, Gsus4, and inversions as C/E (the bottom note after the slash).
- **Voicing...** works on the selected chords (notes that start together): **Invert up** / **Invert down** move the lowest note up an octave or the highest down one, **Spread** opens the chord out, **Close** packs it into an octave, and **Strum up** / **Strum down** start its notes a 32nd apart like a guitar (**Unstrum** lines them up again). Under **Reharmonise**: swap each for the chord **a third down** (C becomes Am) or **a third up** (C becomes Em) in your key, **simplify to triads**, or **make them sevenths**.
- **Step in:** turn it on and each note you play goes in at the cursor, a 16th long; let go and the cursor moves on a 16th (play a chord and it goes in together). The button shows the step it writes next.
- **Import MIDI...** (or drop a .mid file) brings every note of a MIDI file in, up to 8 bars; **Export MIDI...** and the drag handle next to it take the part out to your DAW.
- The sound is the SYNTH tab's: pick a preset there. **Export WAV** includes the part.

## Pad melody



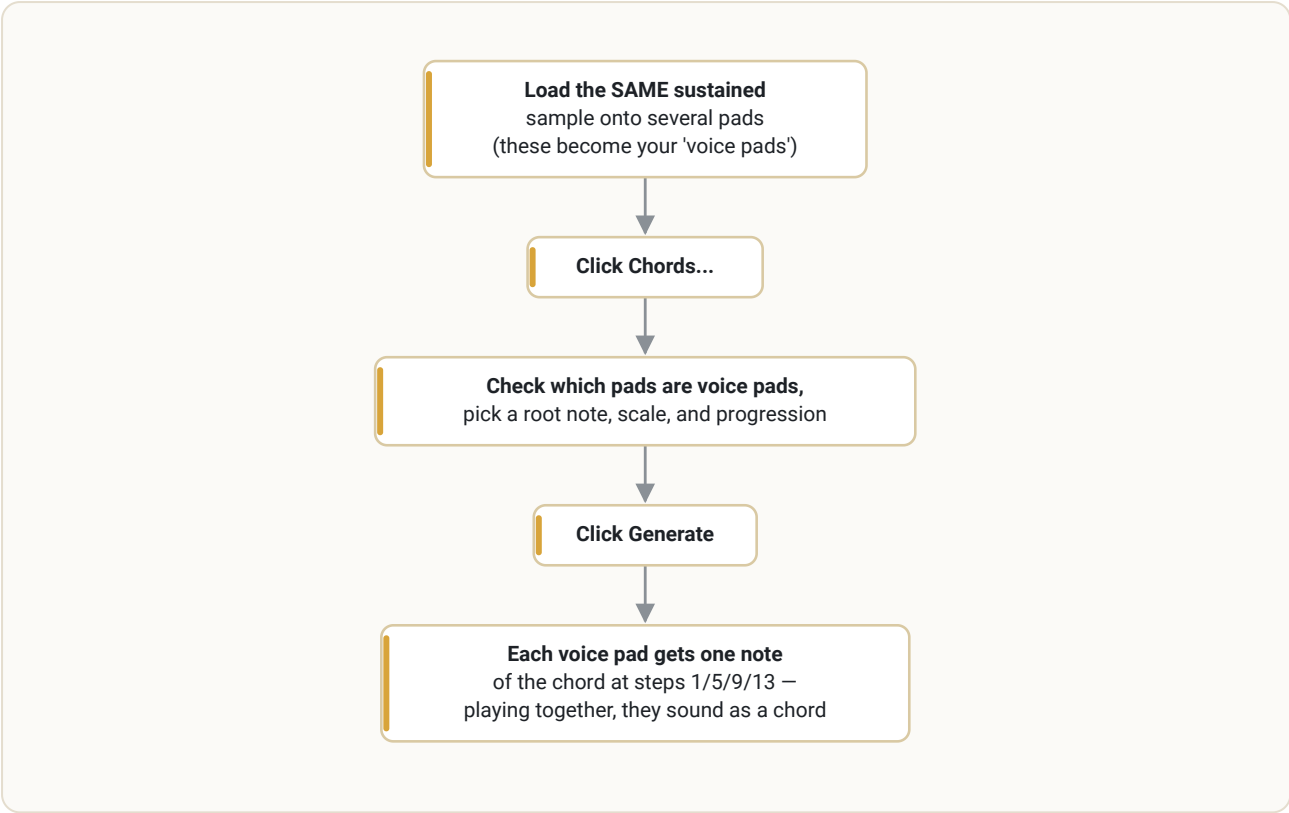

*KEYS: a pad's melody*

A vertical piano keyboard on the left plus a step x pitch grid (as long as the pattern -- up to 4 bars, see SEQ's **Bars**) (the piano roll) on the right, both scrolling together. This always plays and edits whichever pad is currently selected on the PADS tab — it's not a separate instrument, it's a melodic/chromatic way to play and sequence that same pad's sample.

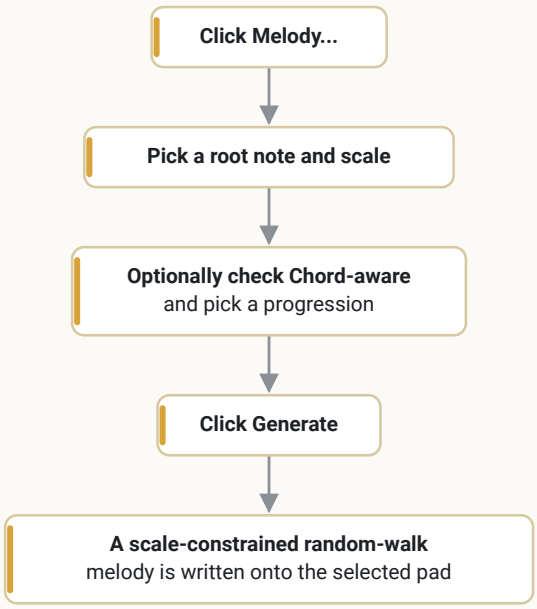
The grid fills the whole panel: the steps stretch to its width, and at the left end of **Zoom** every row fits its height (slide right for taller rows, then scroll). The beat numbers run along the top, and each note's velocity shows in the lane underneath.

- **Click or drag along the keyboard strip** to audition the selected pad at different pitches. The highlighted row is MIDI note 60 (middle C) — that's the pad's own natural pitch (its Tune/Fine settings), with every row above or below shifting by a semitone (±24 semitones total, matching the Tune knob's own range).
- **Three tools** (top left):
  - **Draw**: click an empty spot to place a note (drag right in the same move to make it longer). Drag a note to move it, drag its right edge to resize it. Hold **Alt** (or **Ctrl**) while dragging to copy instead.
  - **Select**: drag a box around notes to select them (**Shift** adds to the selection), then drag them to move or copy them together.
  - **Erase**: click or drag over notes to remove them.
- **Removing a note**: double-click it or right-click it, with any tool.
- **Keys** (after clicking the grid): **Delete** removes the selected notes, **Up/Down** transposes them (**Shift**: an octave), **Left/Right** moves them a step, **Ctrl+A** selects every note, **Esc** clears the selection.

- **Key** and **Scale**: the scale's rows are shaded lighter and the key's own note is tinted, so it's easy to stay in key. Scales: Major, Minor, Harmonic Minor, Dorian, Phrygian, Lydian, Mixolydian, Pentatonic Major and Minor, Blues, Melodic Minor, Locrian, Phrygian Dominant, Double Harmonic, Hungarian Minor, Whole Tone, Diminished, Hirajoshi, Major Blues, and **Custom** -- **Notes...** picks its notes; **None** shows the piano's white and black keys. **Snap to scale** makes new and moved notes land on the scale's notes (on BASS too). Your project remembers all of it. This key is the whole project's: BASS shades it, and a pad's **Key Snap** rounds its Tune onto it.
- **Fold** shows only the scale's notes in the synth part's roll -- every row a note that fits.
- **Move parts**: with it on, changing the key or scale moves the synth part and the bass line into the new key (Undo takes it back).
- **Velocity lane**: drag up or down over a note's bar to set how hard it plays; drag across several bars to draw a shape.
- **Selected note** (bottom row): the note, its length, velocity and chance (how likely it is to play each time round) of the selected note. Change one and every selected note gets it.
- Notes stop (with a short fade, not a hard click) once they reach their length, rather than always playing the pad's full sample. Louder notes look brighter, less likely ones fainter.
- One note per step: this edits the pad's own step pattern. For chords and longer parts, use the **Synth part** (above).
- The playhead highlights the current step in sync with the regular step sequencer — this is the *same* pattern data, just a pitch-and-length-aware view of it. Anything you place here also shows as "on" in the plain step sequencer, and vice versa.
- **Export MIDI...** — saves the selected pad's pattern as a standard `.mid` file, so you can drag it into your DAW's own piano roll/playlist.
- **Import MIDI...** (button, or just drag a `.mid` file onto the panel) — loads a `.mid` file's notes onto the selected pad's pattern, replacing whatever was there. Reads the file's own tempo resolution, so patterns exported from other software should import correctly too.
- **Chords...** generates a chord progression across several pads at once — different from everything else on this tab, which edits one pad's pattern at a time.

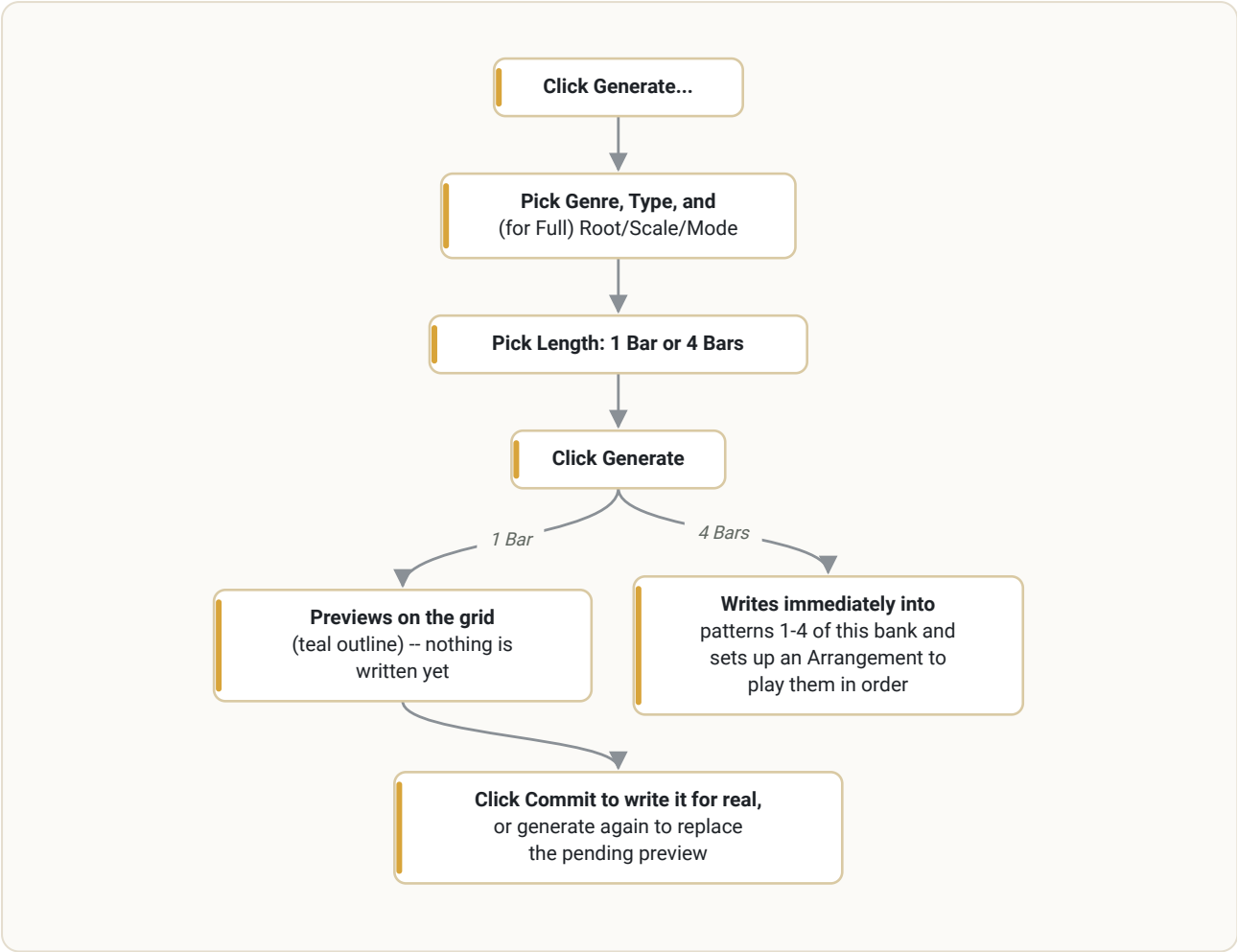



  - This needs pads with the **same sustained sample already loaded** — the button doesn't load anything for you, it only writes pitch/timing into pads you've already prepared.
  - More voice pads than a triad has notes (3) doesn't repeat a pitch — extra voices add the same notes an octave higher instead, so a 5-voice chord still sounds like real harmony, not doubling.
  - Generate **replaces** each checked pad's whole pattern (not a merge) — same one-undo-snapshot safety net as every other generator here.
  - Favorited pads are protected here too.
  - **Use Pad's Key** reads the lowest-numbered checked pad's detected key (shown on its SEQ/PADS tab sample info once loaded) and fills in Root/Scale for you — only works if that pad's sample has a detectable tonal key; the button is just a shortcut, still editable afterward.
  - **Export as .mid...** (inside the same popup) saves whichever checked pads' patterns as one MIDI file — works even before you've clicked Generate, so you can export a chord you built by hand too.
- **Melody...** generates a melody on the currently selected pad — unlike Chords, this only ever touches one pad. **Shape** sets how the line moves over the bar: **Wander**, **Rise**, **Fall**, **Arch**, **Dip**, or **Motif** (a one-beat idea moved up the bar). **Range** keeps it within one or two octaves, **Leaps** limits how far it jumps, **Notes** how many 16ths play; **End on the root** lands the last note home, and **Answer the first half** makes the bar a call and its response. **Write a counter-melody** puts a second line on this pad under the pad you pick in **Counter to**: in harmony on its beats, moving the other way, with passing notes where it rests.




- The melody's pitch drifts up and down within your chosen scale rather than jumping randomly — a more musical result than pure randomization.
- **Use Pad's Key** fills in Root/Scale from this pad's own detected key, same as the Chords popup's button above — disabled if this pad has no detected key.
- **Chord-aware** (checkbox) makes the melody outline a chord progression's notes on each beat instead of freely wandering the scale — pick the same progression you used in the Chords popup to get a melody that fits the chords you already wrote. Off by default.
- Generate **replaces** the pad's whole pattern, same one-undo- snapshot safety net as every other generator here. Favorited pads are protected.

- **Generate...** is the one-stop version of Chords/Melody above — pick a **Genre**, then a **Type**: **Full** (Root/Scale/Mode/Length, writing chords, melody, or both together) or **Rhythm** (Kick/Snare/Closed Hat/Open Hat role assignment, the same drum-generation idea as the SEQ tab's own Generate..., reached from here too). **Mode** (Full type only) picks Chords, Melody, or Both — Chords needs voice pads checked the same way the Chords popup does, Melody needs a target pad picked from a dropdown.




- **1 Bar** only previews — nothing is written to the live pattern until you click the **Commit** button (next to Generate...) that lights up once a preview is ready. Generating again before committing just replaces the pending preview, no separate discard step needed.
- **4 Bars** writes right away into **patterns 1-4** of the bank you're on (see SEQ's pattern slots -- your kit and the other banks stay as they are) and arranges them in sequence. There's no preview step for this size, since it's already a whole song section. If any of patterns 1-4 already has steps, you'll get a one-time confirm prompt first.
- Favorited pads are protected here too, same as every other generator.

CHAPTER 11

# SYNTH




*The SYNTH tab*

A synthesiser, played like an instrument. The tab is an **instrument slot**: the **Instrument** menu at the top holds the Synth now, and more instruments will join it there.

## Playing it

- **The keyboard at the bottom** plays the synth while the SYNTH tab is open (its Mode switches to **Synth**, and back when you leave the tab). You can also pick **Synth** in that Mode menu on any tab.
- **MIDI channel 5** plays it from your DAW, a controller or a MIDI keyboard: notes, pitch bend, the mod wheel, the sustain pedal, aftertouch (pressure) and CC 74 (slide). Nothing else in the plugin listens to channel 5.
- **MPE controllers** (each note on its own channel, so every finger bends, presses and slides on its own): see **MPE** below.
- **Voices playing** (top) shows how many notes are sounding.

## Presets

Pick one from the **Preset** menu, or step through with **<** and **>**: Init, then A to Z: 808, Acid, Arp Bells, Bell, Brass, Choir Pad, Chord Stab, Distorted 808, Dusty Rhodes, Fat Bass, G-Funk Whine, Lo-Fi Keys, Music Box, Organ, Pluck, Pluck Bass, Reese, Saw Lead, Soft Pad, Soul Stab, Square Lead, String Machine, Strings, Sub Bass, Sweep Pad, Warm Keys, Wavetable Sweep, Whistle Lead, Wobble Bass. **Browse...** opens the sound browser (search, categories, tags, favourites -- see the toolbar). **A** / **B** compares two versions of the sound: switch to B, change it, and flip back to A to hear the difference; **A > B** copies the side you're on to the other. Turning knobs, loading a preset or a wavetable are all **Undo** steps.

**Save...** keeps your sound as a preset file (in Documents / Boom Bap Producer Pads / Synth Presets) and it joins the menu under the built-in ones; **Load...** opens one from anywhere. You can also drop a `.bbsynth` file on the tab. Your project saves the synth's whole sound either way.

Double-click any knob to put it back to where Init has it.

## To Pads: resample the sound

**To Pads...** (beside Load...) plays the sound you've made into empty pads, so you can chop it, sequence it on SEQ, put it through the pad effects or export it in a kit like any sample:

| Choose | What you get |
|---|---|
| **One note** | One pad: the note held 1.5 seconds, with its release. |
| **Three velocities, as a velocity group** | Three pads, soft, medium and hard, joined as a velocity group: hit the first pad softly and it plays the soft take, harder and it plays the harder ones (see Layers). |
| **One per octave, over four octaves** | Four pads, an octave apart, from an octave below the note to two above -- set up as **key zones**: select the first pad and play the keyboard, and every note plays the nearest take (see Key zones). |

- The note is your project's key (the KEYS / BASS **Key**), around middle C -- or C if no key is set. The BASS tab's **Edit sound...** has the same button, two octaves lower.
- The pads used are the first empty ones side by side in this bank. If there aren't enough, it says so: clear some or pick a bigger Grid Size.
- The sounds are saved as WAV files in **Music > Boom Bap Captures > Resampled**, by date, so your project keeps them. **Undo** takes the pads back.
- It's the sound itself: the synth's own effects are in it; its mixer strip (volume, pan, bus) isn't.

## The sections

- **OSC 1, OSC 2, OSC 3**: each has a **Wave** (Sine, Triangle, Saw, Pulse, Noise, Wavetable), a **Level** (0 = off), **Octave**, **Semi** and **Fine** (cents). **Shape** is the pulse width for Pulse and the position in the table for Wavetable.
- **Wavetables**: with Wave set to Wavetable, the built-in table sweeps sine to triangle to saw to square as you turn Shape. Click **Table...** (or drop an audio file on the oscillator) to make one from any sound: its first few seconds are cut into single cycles, and Shape moves through them. Try a vocal, a drum loop or a chord -- each gives its own colour.

- **STACK**: **Voices** stacks up to 7 copies of each oscillator, **Detune** spreads their pitch (cents) and **Width** spreads them across left and right -- for thick leads and wide pads. **Sub** adds a sine an octave under OSC 1. **FM 2>1** lets OSC 2 bend OSC 1's wave for bells and metallic tones.
- **FILTER**: **Type**, **Cutoff**, **Reso**, **Drive** (grit before the filter), **Key** (higher notes open the filter more) and **Env** (how far the filter envelope moves the cutoff, up or down). The types:

| Type | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Low 12, Low 24** | Low-pass, gentle or steep. |
| **High 12, High 24** | High-pass. |
| **Band, Notch** | Keeps or cuts a band around the cutoff. |
| **Ladder 24** | A steep low-pass with a round, driven sound; its resonance thins the bass a little, the classic way. |
| **Diode 18** | A gentler, squelchier low-pass that clips one way sooner -- the acid-line sound. |
| **Comb +** | Rings at the pitch the **Cutoff** sets (and its harmonics); **Reso** makes it ring longer. Metallic, plucked, flanged. |
| **Comb -** | The same, ringing between those harmonics -- hollow, an octave down. |
| **Vowel** | Three formants that say A, E, I, O, U as **Cutoff** moves left to right; **Reso** sharpens them. Put the filter envelope or an LFO on it and the synth talks. |

- **FILTER ENV, AMP ENV, MOD ENV**: attack, decay, sustain, release. The amp envelope shapes the volume, the filter envelope the cutoff, and the mod envelope whatever the mod matrix sends it to.
- **LFO 1, LFO 2**: a **Shape** (sine, triangle, saw, square, random) at a **Rate**; **Restart** starts it from the top on every note.
- **MOD MATRIX**: four rows of *source*, *where it goes* and *how much* (drag left for the other way). Sources: the LFOs, the mod envelope, velocity, the mod wheel, a random value per note, the key, **Pressure** (aftertouch) and **Slide** (CC 74) -- per note with MPE. Destinations: pitch, each oscillator's level and shape, cutoff, resonance, FM, volume, pan. Example: LFO 1 to Pitch at a small amount is vibrato; Mod Env to Pitch with a short decay is an 808's punch.
- **SHAPE**: a movement you draw (**Draw...**), its **Length** (1/16 to 4 bars) and **Loop**. It starts with every note. Pick **Shape** as a source in the MOD MATRIX to send it anywhere -- a stepped pitch line, a rhythmic filter, an envelope with as many stages as you like.
- **PLAY**: **Mode** Poly (chords), Mono (one note, restarts the envelopes) or Legato (one note, glides without restarting); **Glide** time; **Bend** range in semitones; **Velocity** (how much playing harder makes it louder); **Voices** (the most notes at once).
- **ARP** (the arpeggiator): switch it **On** and held notes play one at a time, in time with the song -- **Mode** Up, Down, Up-Down, Random or As played; **Rate** 1/4 to 1/32 or triplets; **Octaves** 1-4 (the pattern climbs through them); **Gate** (short and plucky to smooth). When the song is stopped it keeps time at the tempo.
- **CHORD**: every note you play becomes a chord -- Major, Minor, 7th, Minor 7th, Major 7th, Sus2, Sus4, Power, Octave. With the ARP on too, the chord's notes are what it arpeggiates.
- **INSERT 1-3**: effects in order, the same ones the pads have (chorus, flanger, phaser, reverb, delay, saturation and more) with their own knobs and a **Mix**.

- **OUTPUT**: **Volume** and **Pan** (the same as the synth's mixer strip).

## The bottom row: character

- **DRIFT**: an old analogue polysynth never plays two notes quite alike -- each voice is a little off in pitch, filter and envelope, and wanders. **Drift** is how much (0 is steady, as before); **Pitch**, **Filter**, **Env** and **Glide** share it out (Pitch moves up to 20 cents, Filter up to about half an octave). Each voice keeps its own character, so a chord sounds wider and alive rather than random. **Voice Pan** spreads the voices across left and right, each voice in its own place.
- **FILTER 2**: a second filter, any of the types above (**Off** is one filter, as before), with its own **Cutoff**, **Reso** and **Env**. Key and Drive are the first filter's. **Routing**: **Serial** runs filter 2 after filter 1 (a low-pass and a high-pass in series make a band); **Parallel** runs them side by side, and **1 / 2** mixes them (left: filter 1 only, right: filter 2 only, the middle both). Cutoff in the mod matrix moves both.
- **RESPONSE**: what the filters do to the sound, drawn from 20 Hz to 20 kHz (the lines are 100 Hz, 1 kHz and 10 kHz; the flat line is 0 dB). It follows the knobs: the envelopes and the mod matrix move it further as you play.
- **LAYERS**: two sounds in one synth. **One** is a single sound. **Split** plays layer **B** below the **Split** key and layer A from it up -- a bass under your left hand, keys under the right. **Stack** plays both on every note -- a pad under a pluck. **A** and **B** choose which layer the knobs edit (the section titles say **- B** while you edit B); each layer has its own oscillators, filters, envelopes, LFOs, mod matrix, play mode, inserts and output. **B Sound...** gives layer B a built-in sound or a copy of layer A. The ARP and CHORD play both layers. Presets: a built-in preset is one sound and goes to layer A, leaving B and the layer settings as they are; a saved preset (**Save...**) and your project keep both layers.
- **MPE**: for controllers that put each note on its own channel (an MPE keyboard or pad surface, or a DAW's MPE clip). **Off**: the synth plays channel 5 only, as always. **Ch 5-16**: it takes channels 5 to 16 (set your controller to an MPE *upper zone*, channel 16 the master) and channels 1-4 still play the pads and bass. **All ch**: it takes every channel (a *lower zone*, channel 1 the master) and nothing else in the plugin hears MIDI. Each note's own bend moves it by **Note Bend** semitones (48 is the MPE standard); the master channel's bend moves all notes by the PLAY **Bend** range. Pressure and slide come into the mod matrix as **Pressure** and **Slide** -- for example Pressure to Volume or Cutoff, Slide to Cutoff.

The BASS tab's **Edit sound...** has DRIFT, FILTER 2 and RESPONSE too, but no layers or MPE: the bass is one sound, played as a line.

## In the mixer

The MIXER tab has a **Synth** strip after the Bass: volume, pan, **Duck** (dips it when a duck-source pad plays), mute, solo and its meter. **Routing...** there can send it to Bus A or Bus B. See the MIXER tab.

CHAPTER 12

# BASS




*The BASS tab*

**One bass line, one note at a time -- and notes can slide into each other.** Pick a sound at the top, then draw the line in the grid. The bass has its own strip in the MIXER and doesn't use a pad.

## 1. Pick a sound

**Sound: Synth or Sample.**

- **Synth** (the default) is a bass synth, ready to play. Pick a preset -- **808**, **Distorted 808**, **Sub Bass**, **Reese**, **Acid**, **Fat Bass**, **Pluck Bass**, **Wobble Bass** -- or step through them with **<** and **>**. Then shape it with six knobs:
  - **Tone**: darker to brighter.
  - **Punch**: the 808 knock -- each note starts higher and drops onto its pitch.
  - **Drive**: grit and weight, so it cuts through small speakers.
  - **Length**: how long each note rings.
  - **Glide**: how long a slide takes to reach the next note.
  - **Sub**: a pure low sine an octave under, for weight.

**Edit sound...** opens every control of the synth (the same ones as the SYNTH tab: oscillators, filter, envelopes, LFOs, mod matrix, effects) and every preset, and you can save your own. **< Back to the bass line** returns.




*Edit sound: the bass synth's every control*

- **Sample** plays your own bass sound (an 808 you like, a sub, a bass note): **Load...** it or drop it on the tab. Its knobs are the sample's filter (**Cutoff**, **Res**), envelope (**Attack**, **Decay**, **Sustain**, **Release**), **Tune**, **Fine**, **Glide** time and **Loop**. Right-click a knob to MIDI-learn it.

**Volume** and **Pan** (right) work for both, and are the same as the BASS strip in the MIXER.

## 2. Draw the line

The grid is a small piano roll: notes up the side, steps across (16 per bar).

- **Click** to add a note. It holds until the next note starts, which is what most 808 lines want (the rest of a held note shows lighter). Drag right as you click to give it a set length instead.
- **Drag a note** to move it (up and down changes its note), or drag its right edge to change its length.
- **Right-click** or **double-click** a note to remove it.
- One note at a time: a new note inside a held one ends it there.
- **Scroll** over the grid to see higher or lower notes. The keyboard on the left plays a note when you click it.
- If you've set a **Key** and **Scale** on the KEYS tab, the grid shades the notes in that key (and says so, top right) -- stay on the lighter rows and the bass fits the rest of the beat.

Under the grid, one cell per note:

- **Slide**: glide into this note from the one before instead of starting it fresh (the note before has to run up to it). The Glide knob sets how long the slide takes.

- **Accent**: play this note harder.
- **Right-click** a note's Slide or Accent cell to pick when it plays: **1:2** (the 1st of every 2 times round the line), **2:4**, **Fill** (only while Fill is held), **First**, **Prev** (when the line's last such note played) and their opposites (**!**). The choice shows on the Accent cell.
- **Velocity**: drag the bars up or down.
- **Recording:** with **Record** armed and the beat playing, notes you play on MIDI channel 4 go into the line on their nearest step, as long as you held them.
- **Step in:** turn it on and each note you play on channel 4 goes in at the cursor (one step long); let go and the cursor moves on a step.
- **Humanize** moves each note's velocity a little at random; **Swing: kit** gives the line its own swing (kit = the PADS Swing).
- **Chords** (on by default) shades, under each step, the notes of the KEYS synth part's chord playing there -- land the bass on them to follow the harmony. **Follow chords** does it for you: every note moves to the nearest of those chord notes (notes already on one stay; Undo takes it back).

## 3. Tools

- **Bars 1, 2, 3, 4, 8 or 16**: how long the line is. Going longer starts the new bars as copies of the ones you have.
- **Octave - / Octave +**: every note down or up an octave.
- **Clear**: remove every note.
- **Generate...**: write a line from a chord progression's root notes, across every bar. It opens on the KEYS tab's key; use the same Root, Scale and Progression as your chord pads to keep them together.

## Playing it live

The keyboard at the bottom plays the bass while the BASS tab is open (its Mode switches to **Bass**, and back when you leave). From a DAW or controller, **MIDI channel 4** plays it.

## Your older projects

A project saved before this version keeps its bass line (moved into the grid as it was) and, if it had a bass sample, plays that sample. Projects without one get the Synth's 808.

CHAPTER 13

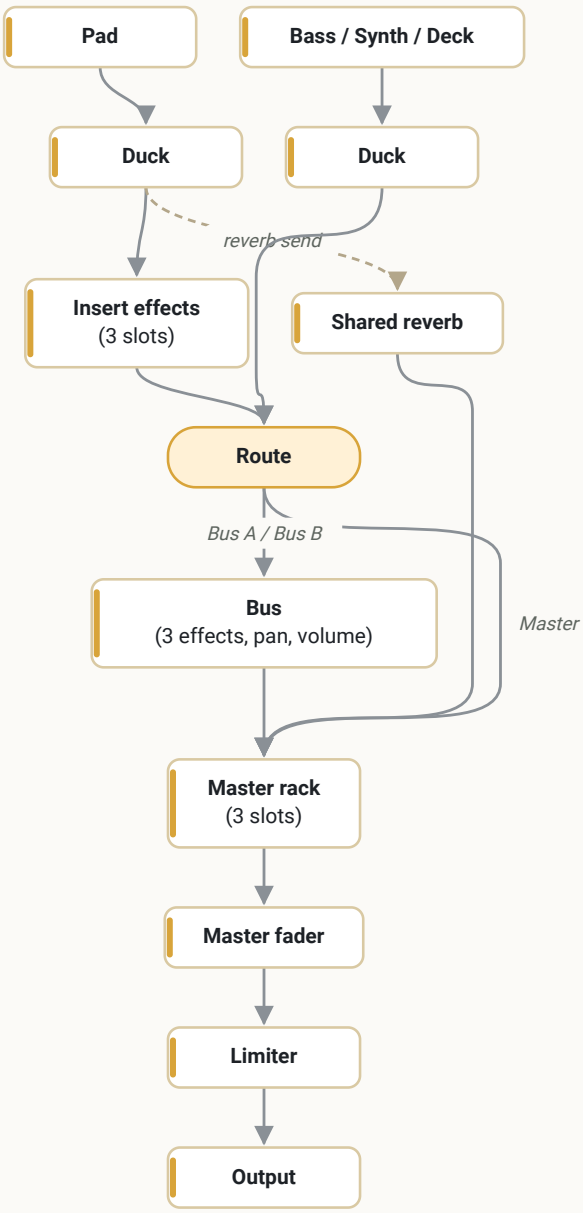
# MIXER




*The MIXER tab*

A console-style row of vertical channel strips — one per sound source in the plugin (every pad in the active bank's grid size, the bass, the synth and both turntable decks), plus the **Master** strip pinned first on the left and **Bus A** and **Bus B** beside it. Everything here is the same underlying parameters the PADS/BASS/TURNTABLE tabs already control, just laid out side by side for a whole-kit view instead of one source at a time.

- **Solo-active banner** (above the strips) — shown whenever anything in the kit is soloed, so silence elsewhere in the mix reads as "something's soloed," not "broken."
- **Signal Flow** — opens a plain explainer of the signal path below.




The **Duck** dips a source each time a pad marked **D** plays (the sidechain pump); the duck-source pad itself never ducks.

## Every strip

- **Pan** knob and a vertical **Volume** fader.
- **M** / **S** — Mute and Solo, same cross-source behavior as elsewhere in the plugin (soloing one source silences every other un-soloed source).
- A thin peak meter down the side of the strip.

## Pad strips only

- **3 insert-effect slots** at the top — the same per-pad Insert FX chain from the pad grid's right-click menu, shown here as clickable slots instead. Picking a type here and via right-click on the pad are the same setting either way.
- The strip's top accent bar reflects the pad's own color tag (set via right-click → Color on the PADS tab) instead of a fixed color, so a glance across the console tells you which strips belong to which color-grouped pads.
- A reverb send level and a **D** (duck source) control with its own amount — sends this pad into a shared reverb bus, or marks it as a sidechain-ducking source for other pads to duck against.

## Master strip

Leftmost, always visible. Volume fader and a live peak meter — no pan/mute/solo, since there's nothing to pan or solo on an already-summed master bus. Its **FX** button opens the same 3-slot master rack popup as the toolbar's own Master FX button — one rack, two entry points.




*The master rack*

## Bass, Synth and Turntable strips

At the right end of the console (scroll across to them):

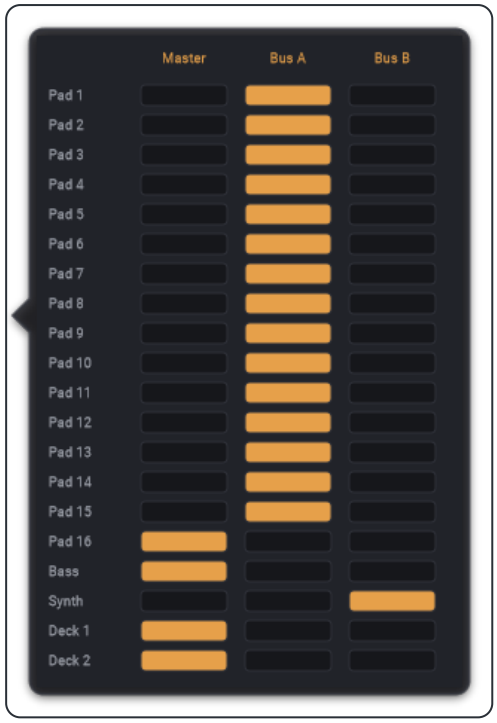



*The last strips: bass, synth and the decks*

Same Pan/Volume/Mute/Solo/meter as any strip, plus a **Duck** knob: how far it dips each time a pad marked **D** (duck source, on the pad strips) plays. Turn it up on the Bass so the 808 makes room for the kick -- the classic sidechain pump -- or on the Synth for a pumping pad.

## Bus A and Bus B

Next to the master: two group buses. Send several sources to one bus and treat them together -- all the drums through one saturation for glue, the synth and a deck through a shared delay.




*Routing: every source against Master, Bus A and Bus B*

- **Routing...** (top left of the MIXER) shows every source -- each pad, the Bass, the Synth, both decks -- against **Master**, **Bus A** and **Bus B**. Click a cell to send that source there. Everything starts on the Master.
- A bus has three **insert slots** (click one for an effect; **Knobs...** in the same menu sets its controls), **Pan**, **Volume**, **Mute** and a meter. It joins the master before the master rack.
- A pad sent to its own output in your DAW (multi-out) still goes there, not to a bus.
- **Export WAV** and **Export Full Song** render the mix the way you hear it: each pad's effects, sends and Duck, the buses, the master rack, the Master fader and the safety limiter.

## The EQ

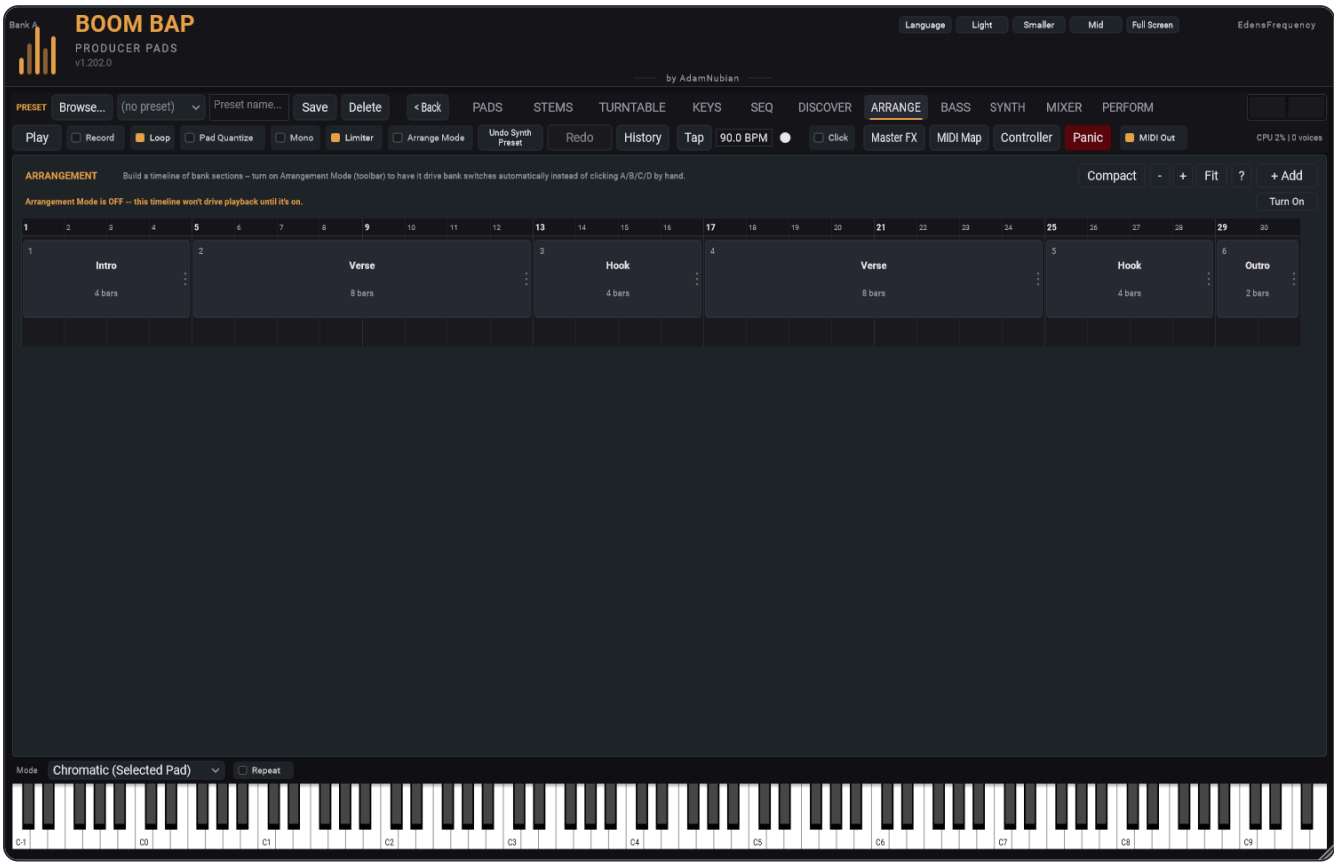
Any insert slot -- a pad's, Bus A / B's or the master rack's -- can hold an **EQ**. Pick it, then choose **Edit EQ...** from the same menu (or click the slot's button):

- The curve sits over a live picture of the sound. **Before / After** shows what goes in or what comes out.
- **Bands 1-4**: drag a round handle sideways for its frequency, up or down for boost or cut; the mouse wheel over it makes it wider or narrower; double-click puts it back. Each band is a **Bell**, **Low Shelf** or **High Shelf**.
- **Low cut / High cut**: the square handles. Turn one on and pick how steep it is (12 to 48 dB/oct).
- **Dynamic** on a band: it only moves while its own frequencies are louder than the **Threshold**, by up to the **Range** (negative cuts, positive boosts) -- tame a boomy note only when it booms.
- **Output** sets the level after the EQ; **Flat** resets everything.

A slot switched to EQ starts flat. The EQ is saved with your project, the bank, kits and the pad's A/B, and sounds the same in Export WAV.

CHAPTER 14

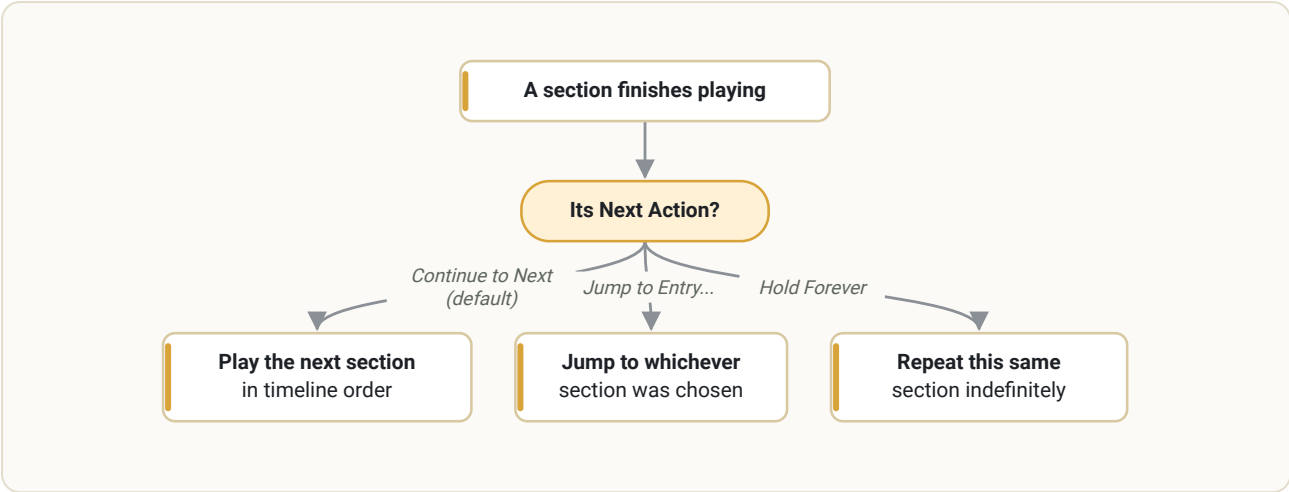
# ARRANGE




*The ARRANGE tab*

Build a timeline out of your 4 kit banks (see The pad grid & sample browser for what a bank is) — sections you can arrange into a song structure instead of switching banks by hand.

- **+ Add** — adds a new section (4 bars, same bank as the last section you added).
- **Double-click** a section, or right-click and choose **Rename...**, to give it a name (e.g. "Intro", "Chorus") — leave it blank to fall back to showing which bank it plays.
- **Drag a section's right edge** to resize it, in whole bars.
- **Drag a section** to reorder it within the timeline — a gold line shows where it'll land.
- **Right-click → Edit Next Action...** to choose what happens when a section finishes:
  - **Continue to Next** (default) — play the next section in order.
  - **Jump to Entry...** — jump to a specific other section instead. The section shows a curved arrow to its target, plus a small "-> N" label.
  - **Hold Forever** — repeat this section indefinitely. Shown with a small looping-arrow icon on the section itself.




- **Right-click → Pattern** picks which of the bank's 16 patterns the section plays ("Whatever the bank is on" leaves it to the bank). The block shows it as "/ P3".
- **Right-click → Key** plays the section's synth part and bass line a few semitones up or down (-5 to +6) -- a key change for a chorus or a last section. The block shows it as "/ +2".
- **Right-click → Duplicate** adds a copy of a section right after it; **Right-click → Delete** removes it.
- Each section's block width is proportional to its length in bars, so longer sections are visibly wider.
- **The view:** a ruler with bar numbers along the top and **Zoom in**, **Zoom out** and **Fit** (the whole song in view). The button beside them switches to the **Compact** view (plain blocks, no ruler) and back. **?** explains the tab in a few lines.

**Arrangement Mode** (toolbar toggle, next to Limiter, or the **Turn On** button in the bar that says it's off) turns the timeline on: while it's on, playback advances through your sections automatically following each section's Next Action — a gold highlight shows which one is currently playing — and the SEQ tab's A/B/C/D bank buttons are disabled, since the timeline is what's driving bank switches now. Turn it back off to return to switching banks by hand.

CHAPTER 15

# TURNTABLE




*The TURNTABLE tab, two decks and the crossfader*

One dedicated deck with its own sample slot, not tied to pad selection. The platter sits on the left at a much larger size than other tabs' controls; everything else lives in a scrollable strip on the right, and the **Chop** lane runs along the bottom (see Deck Chop below): it chops whatever's on the deck straight onto your pads.

- **Full Screen** (or press **E**) — hides everything but the platter and a small Play/Cue strip, for an uncluttered view while performing. Press **Escape**, or click the button again, to return.
- **Load...** or **drag an audio file** onto the panel to load a sample onto the deck. A **video** works too: its soundtrack loads like any record (also from DISCOVER's **Send to Deck**).
- **Click-drag the platter** to scratch: dragging clockwise plays forward, counter-clockwise reverses, and the pitch follows how fast you drag. Release to resume normal playback from wherever the scratch left off.
- **Play / Pause** — normal playback at the current pitch.
- **Cue** — stops and jumps back to the start.
- **Pitch** fader — 0.5x–2.0x playback speed when not scratching.
- **Volume** fader — deck output level.
- **EQ / Filter / Reverb** — Low/Mid/High EQ (±24dB), a Filter knob (sweeps low-pass to high-pass through a neutral centre), and a Reverb send, all real host-automatable parameters.

- **Loop** — repeats a beat-length region from wherever playback currently is (needs a detected BPM, see the BPM/Key readout).
- **Stutter** — hold-to-engage rapid retrigger of a short slice, rate selectable (1/4 to 1/32).
- **Scratch Patterns** — Baby/Scribble/Chirp presets replay a canned scratch gesture; **Record** captures your own platter moves as a named custom pattern to replay later. The fader-work patterns are under Perform below.
- **Vinyl Sim** — Wow/Flutter, Vinyl Noise, and Saturation knobs (0–100%, no effect at 0) plus a **Motor Ramp** toggle (spins up to speed from a stop instead of starting instantly). All off by default.

## Perform

DJ moves, in the control column under Scratch Patterns (scroll down to see them). They run inside the audio engine, so a fader click lands exactly where it should, and the patterns follow your **project tempo**.

**Scratch patterns with the fader** — each plays one bar: a hand rocking the record plus a crossfader cutting the sound, then the record is back exactly where it started.

| Pattern | What it sounds like |
|---|---|
| **Transform** | The sound chopped into four quick stabs every beat while the record rocks back and forth |
| **Crab** | Four very fast taps on each push of the record |
| **Flare** | Each push starts open and is clicked off once in the middle — two sounds per push |
| **Orbit** | A flare on the push *and* on the pull |
| **Tear** | The push stalls halfway, splitting it into two sounds, with the fader open |
| **Stab** | A quick hard push with the sound cut right after the attack |

The running pattern's button lights orange.

- **Brake** — the record slows to a stop, like hitting stop on a real turntable. (Scratch Speed sets how long it takes.)
- **Spinback** — throws the record backwards, then it stops.
- **Censor** — hold it and the playing record runs backwards; let go and it plays forward again.
- **Slip** — turn it on and scratching, Censor, Stutter, Loop and the patterns all happen *over* the record without moving it: a silent playhead keeps going underneath, and when you let go the record jumps to where it would have been. Your scratch stays in time with the beat.
- **Hot cues 1–8** — click an empty one to mark the playhead there (it turns gold); click a gold one to jump to it and play. Shift+click clears it. Jumps fade out and in over about a millisecond, so they don't click. Cues are saved with your project, and cleared when you load a different record.
- **< and >** — jump back or forward by the amount in the box (1 beat up to 4 bars), using the record's tempo.

### Stems

**Stems** splits the record on the deck into its **vocals**, **drums**, **bass** and **other** (everything else: keys, guitars, strings), so you can drop the vocal out, play only the drums, or bring the bass back in on the one.

1. The first time, press **Get separator**. It downloads the separator (about 250 MB, once): HT-Demucs, the separation model, and ONNX Runtime, which runs it. Everything then runs on your computer: there's no account or key, and your music is never uploaded.
2. Load a record and press **Separate**. Splitting takes a while -- on a typical laptop about twice as long as the record lasts, so a 4-minute record takes about 8 minutes. The deck keeps playing while it works, and **Cancel** stops it. The result is kept, so the next time you load that record its stems are ready straight away.
3. Click **Vocals**, **Drums**, **Bass** or **Other** to switch that part on or off (gold = on). Shift+click plays that part on its own; Shift+click it again to bring them all back. Parts fade in and out over a few milliseconds, so they don't click.

With every part on, you hear the original record, untouched. Scratching, loops, hot cues, Slip and the patterns all work on the stems too. Stems are separated per deck, and a record's stems are kept in `%APPDATA%\Boom Bap Producer Pads\Stems` (delete that folder to free the space; the plugin makes them again when asked).

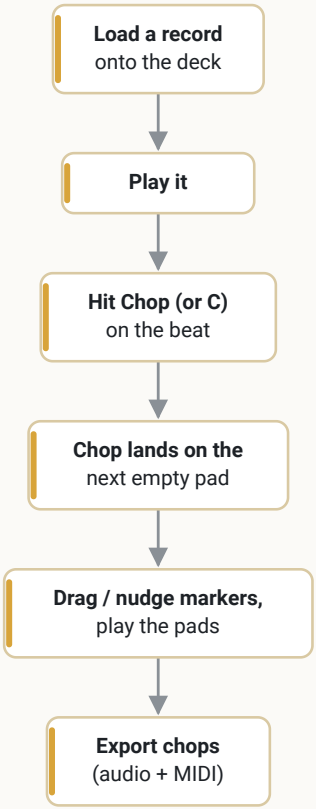
On a DJ controller, the **STEMS** pads work the stems once a record has them: see Pad modes.

The platter also responds to an external MIDI jog-wheel controller, not just mouse drag: Note On/Off at note 20 touches/releases the platter, and CC 20 carries relative jog motion (the standard sign-magnitude relative-encoder convention most DJ jog wheels already speak) — both on MIDI channel 1. Useful if you're driving this from a hardware controller or a DAW MIDI script rather than the mouse.

**A real DJ controller:** press **DJ Controller** (top left of this tab), switch your controller on, and teach the plugin its jog wheels, Play/Cue/Sync, faders, EQ, crossfader and pads: both decks follow it. See Using a DJ controller.

## Deck Chop

Chop a record the way you'd do it on hardware: put it on the deck, play it, and hit a button on the beat. Every chop lands on a pad straight away and is playable immediately. There's no separate "commit" step, because the markers on the waveform **are** the pads: move a marker and its pad changes with it.




- **Chop** (or press **C**) — drops a chop at the playhead onto the lowest-numbered empty pad of the current bank. Works while the record plays (chop by ear) or while it's paused (chop exactly where you stopped). **Double-click** anywhere on the waveform to chop at that point instead.
- **Auto...** — chops the whole record for you, onto the empty pads: *Every hit*, *Only the big hits*, *Every bar*, *Every beat* (from the record's tempo, settling onto its real hits), *8* or *16 chops* (strong phrase starts, on the beat first), or *8 random chops*. One Ctrl+Z takes the whole lot back. These are the same slice modes as the Sample Editor's Slice row. **Into the next empty bank** has the same choices, but chops into a fresh bank (one with no sounds and no pattern) and switches to it, so your current kit stays as it is.
- **The mini pad grid** (right of the waveform) shows the current bank: gold pads are chops of this record, grey pads hold other samples, and grey pads **outlined in gold** are chops of the record you had on before. Tap an **empty** pad to chop onto that exact pad at the playhead; tap any other pad to play it. **Right-click** a pad to clear it (or to clear all the old chops at once).
- **Markers** — each chop is a numbered flag; the number is its pad. Click a flag to hear the pad, **drag** it to move the chop, or select it and press **Left/Right** to nudge it 10ms (hold **Shift** for 1ms). **Delete** (or right-click → Delete) removes the chop and empties its pad. Every one of these is undoable with **Ctrl+Z**.
- **Gate** (on by default) — each chop stops where the next one starts, so every pad is its own clean slice. Turn it off to let chops play on to the end of the record, e.g. to start a longer phrase from a pad.
- **Snap** — Off, 1/4, 1/8 or 1/16: chops land on the record's beat grid, worked out from its detected BPM and lined up on your first chop (so the first chop is where you say the beat is; the grid follows from there). The grid shows on the waveform while Snap is on (zoom in if it's too dense to draw).
- **1/2** and **x2** — tempo detectors often read a record at double or half its real tempo (a 94 BPM record read as 188). Fix it here; the deck's Sync and Loop use the corrected tempo too, and it's saved with your project.

- **Offset** — if your by-ear chops keep landing a hair late (you hear the beat a few milliseconds after it plays), pull this negative. It only applies to chops taken while the record is playing. Double-click to reset to 0.
- **Tap Pads** (off by default) — when on, hitting an **empty** pad on the PADS tab or on your MIDI controller while the deck plays lays a chop on that pad, right then. Leave it off if a DAW MIDI clip plays the pads while the deck runs, or that clip would lay chops too.
- **Stretch** — time-stretches every chop pad to your project's tempo without changing its pitch, and follows the tempo if it changes. Needs the record's BPM (fix it with 1/2 / x2 first if it's wrong).
- **-**, **Fit**, **+** zoom the waveform (or **Ctrl + mouse wheel**; the wheel on its own scrolls). While the record plays, the view follows the playhead.
- **Export...** — pick a folder and you get one audio file per chop, numbered in record order with its pad in the name, plus a MIDI file that plays the chops back on the pads in their original order and timing. Drag both into your DAW.
- **Clear** — removes chops from the current bank: this record's, or the old chops of the record you had on before (see below). If there are both, it asks which. Ctrl+Z brings them back.

Good to know:

- Chops go into the **current bank** only. A 4x4 bank holds 16 chops; pick a bigger grid on the PADS tab (up to 8x8) for up to 64, or switch bank and keep chopping.
- Chop never overwrites a pad that already holds a sample: when the bank is full it tells you instead.
- Loading a different record onto the deck leaves your existing chops on their pads, fully playable; they just stop being editable markers. The lane tells you how many are left, the mini grid outlines them in gold, and **Clear** removes them all in one go, making room for the new record's chops.
- Chops are ordinary pads everywhere else: sequence them on SEQ, shape them with DSP, mix them on MIXER. Your project saves them like any other pad, and they come back as editable chops.
- Only deck 1 has the Chop lane. In **Full Screen** the lane hides, but **C** still chops.

## Chop a pad again

Any pad can go back onto the deck to be chopped further: a chop of a chop, a drum hit cut into smaller pieces, a phrase re-sliced on a different beat. Right-click the pad on the PADS tab and choose:

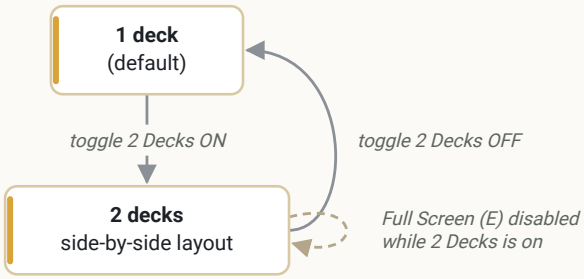
- **Send to deck 1, to chop again**: the pad's slice exactly as it is.
- **Send to deck 1 as it sounds**: the pad the way you hear it, with its Tune, Fine, Speed, Reverse, filter, envelope, LFO, bitcrush and insert effects (reverb, delay, saturation...) printed in, the reverb or delay's tail included. Use it to lock in a pitched-down chop before cutting it up again.
- **Send to deck 2** and **Send to deck 2 as it sounds**: the same, onto the second deck, to play or scratch against deck 1. The two-deck view comes up by itself.

The sound lands on the deck and the TURNTABLE tab opens, ready to play and chop (only deck 1 has the Chop lane). New chops only fill **empty** pads, so the pad you sent (and every other pad) stays as it is; when the bank is full, switch bank and keep going. You can go round as many times as you like: deck, pads, deck.

Each sent pad is saved as a WAV file in your Music folder, under **Boom Bap Pad Bounces**, named after the pad (like `Pad 3 - Break (as it sounds).wav`). Your project remembers the deck's record by that file, so keep the folder; delete files from it once you no longer need them.

## 2 Decks

Toggle **2 Decks** (top of the tab) to bring in a second, fully independent deck — its own sample slot, platter, EQ/Filter/Reverb, Vinyl Sim, scratch patterns, and MIDI Learn mappings, running alongside the first. Everything documented above applies identically to both; they don't share state or interact with each other beyond both being audible at once.




- With 2 Decks on, the platters split **left/right** instead of one platter filling the space — each half is a complete, independent deck.
- **Full Screen is unavailable while 2 Decks is on** (there'd be two platters competing for the same full-screen space) — turn 2 Decks off first if you want the single-deck Full Screen view.
- Turning 2 Decks off doesn't unload or reset deck 2 — it's just hidden; turn it back on and deck 2 is exactly where you left it.
- Deck 2's sample, settings, and MIDI Learn mappings are saved with your project/preset the same as deck 1's.

### Crossfader

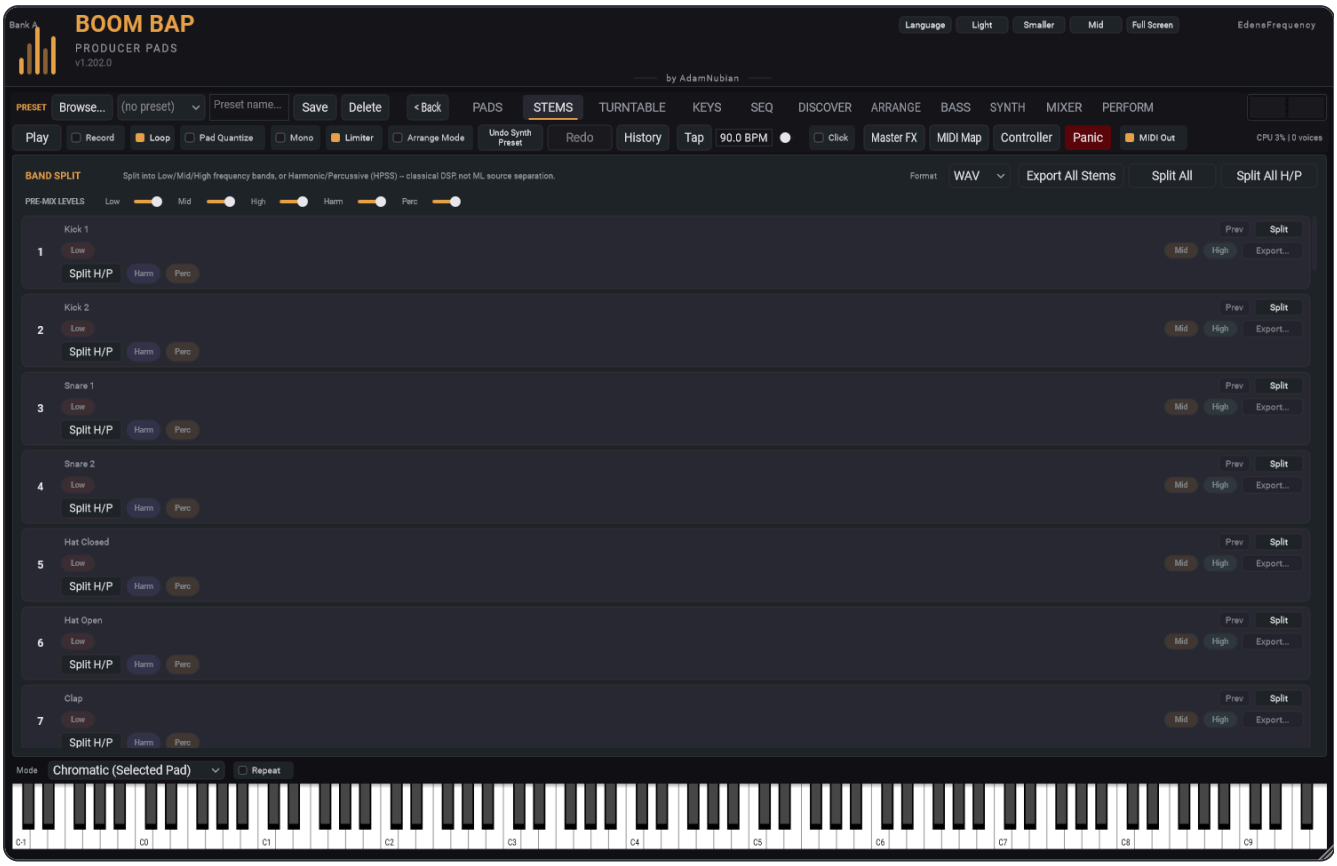
With 2 Decks on, a **crossfader** appears across the top: left plays deck 1, right plays deck 2. Double-click it to centre it, right-click it for **MIDI Learn** (put it on a real fader), and pick how it blends:

| Curve | In the middle | Good for |
|---|---|---|
| **Dipless** (default) | Both decks at full level | Layering, and never changing a one-deck session |
| **Smooth** | Both a little quieter, an even blend | Mixing from one record into another |
| **Scratch** | Both full; each deck cuts out only at the very edge | Fader tricks — a tiny move cuts the sound |

**Reverse** swaps the ends (sometimes called "hamster" style). The crossfader and its settings are saved with your project and can be automated from your DAW.

CHAPTER 16

# STEMS



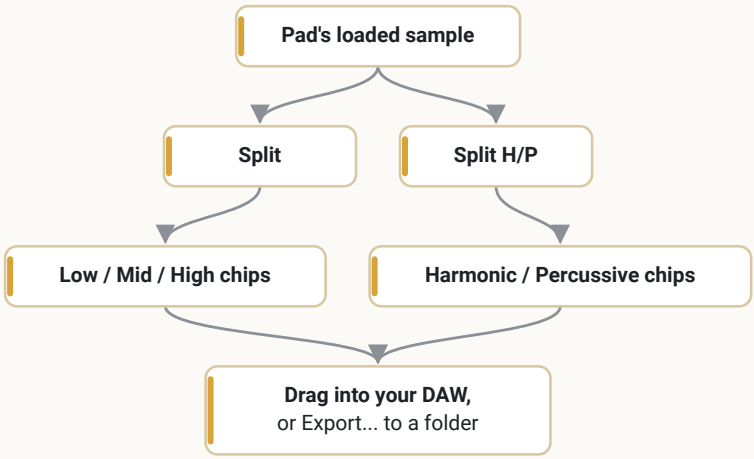

*The STEMS tab*

Splits a pad's sample into three frequency bands — **Low / Mid / High** — using filters. This is **not** AI/ML source separation: it can't cleanly pull an isolated vocal, drum, or bass part out of a full mix, since it only splits by frequency, not by instrument. It's most useful for pulling apart the tonal range of a single one-shot, not remixing a full song. For a record's real **vocals, drums, bass and other**, use the deck's **Stems** on the TURNTABLE tab.

- **Format: WAV / AIFF** (top right) — which format Split and Export... write. Changing it only affects files written from now on — anything already split stays in whatever format it was written in.
- **Split** (per pad row) — splits that pad's currently-loaded sample, writing three files (`..._Low`, `..._Mid`, `..._High`, extension per the Format choice above) into a `Stems` subfolder next to the original sample file.
- **Split All** — runs Split on every pad that currently has a sample loaded.
- After a successful split, three small chips appear per row (**Low / Mid / High**) — **drag any chip** straight into your DAW's playlist/browser to pull that band in directly, or click **Export...** to copy all three to a folder of your choice.
- **Split H/P** / **Split All H/P** — a second, independent split into **Harmonic** (sustained/tonal content) and **Percussive** (transient/ drum-hit content), writing `..._Harmonic` / `..._Percussive` (same Format choice) into the same `Stems` folder. Also classical DSP, not AI/ML — and still not a replacement for the Low/Mid/High

split above, you can run both on the same pad. Works best on material with real sustain (chords, vocal chops, pads); on pure drum breaks the two won't separate as cleanly.

- **Right-click any chip** for "Send to next empty pad" — loads that stem straight onto the next pad with nothing on it, no manual drag-and-drop needed.
- If you load a different sample onto a pad after splitting, that row's chips and Export button reset — they only ever point at bands/stems that actually match what's currently loaded.



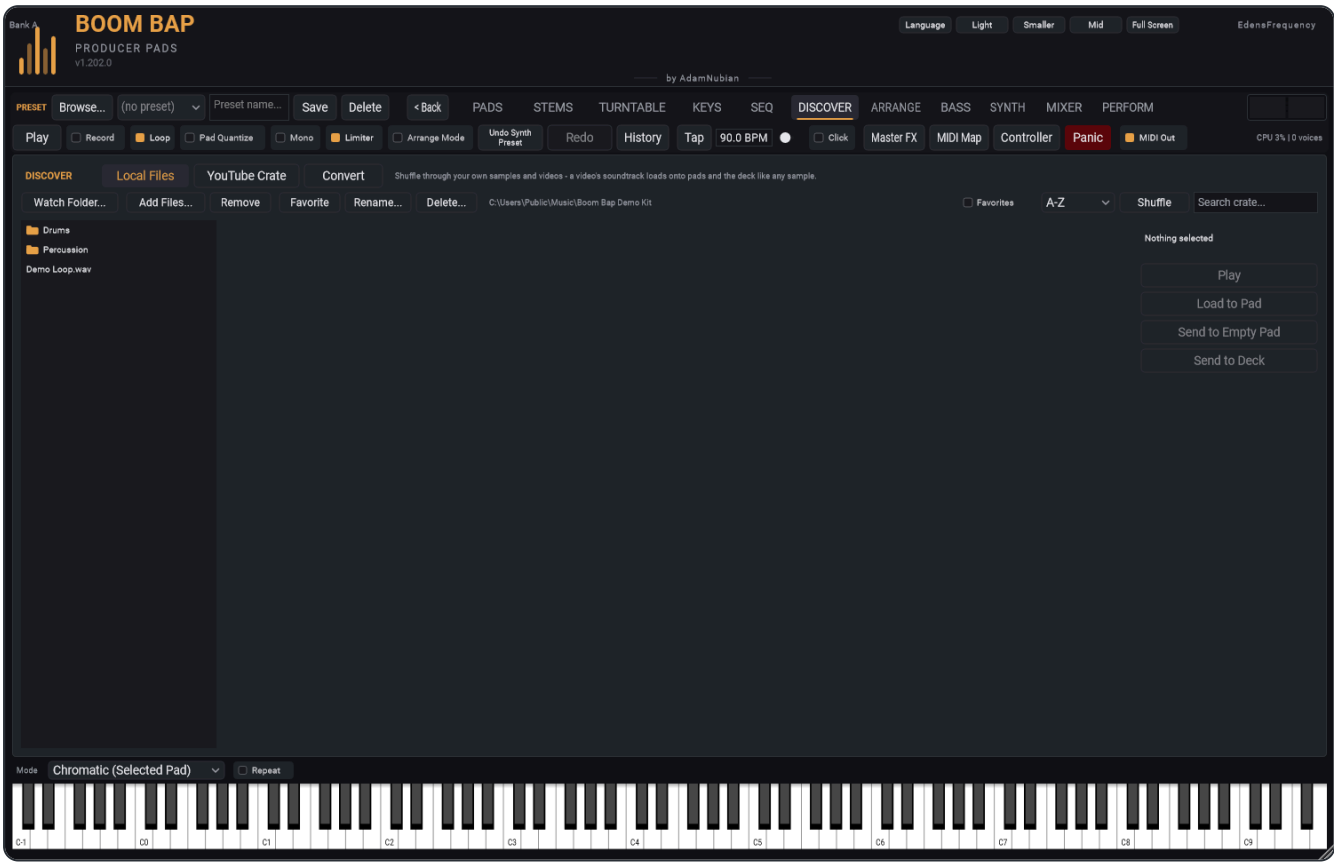

## Pre-mix levels & live preview

Five sliders (**Low / Mid / High / Harm / Perc**) sit above the pad list — real, host-automatable parameters, one per stem type, shared across every pad (only one pad's stems are ever being previewed or exported at a time, so there's one set of levels rather than a separate five per pad). They default to 100%.

- Each pad row has a small **Prev** button (next to Split) once that row has been split — click it to audition that row's stems mixed live at the current slider levels; it turns into **Stop** while playing.
- Adjust the sliders while previewing to hear the balance change live.
- **Export** now bakes the current levels into the files it writes — a stem left at 100% is untouched (identical to before this existed), but dial one down and the exported WAV comes out quieter, letting you balance stems by ear before committing to files.

CHAPTER 17

# DISCOVER




*The DISCOVER tab*

Three sub-tabs: **Local Files** (a crate/shuffle audition browser over your own local sample/video library), **YouTube Crate** (filter, search, and get suggestions from YouTube videos you've tagged yourself) and **Convert** (turn audio files and videos into WAV, AIFF, FLAC or OGG, a whole folder at a time). Nothing here downloads or fetches anything automatically — Local Files and Convert only work with media you already have on disk, and YouTube Crate only embeds videos the same way any website embeds one.

## Local Files

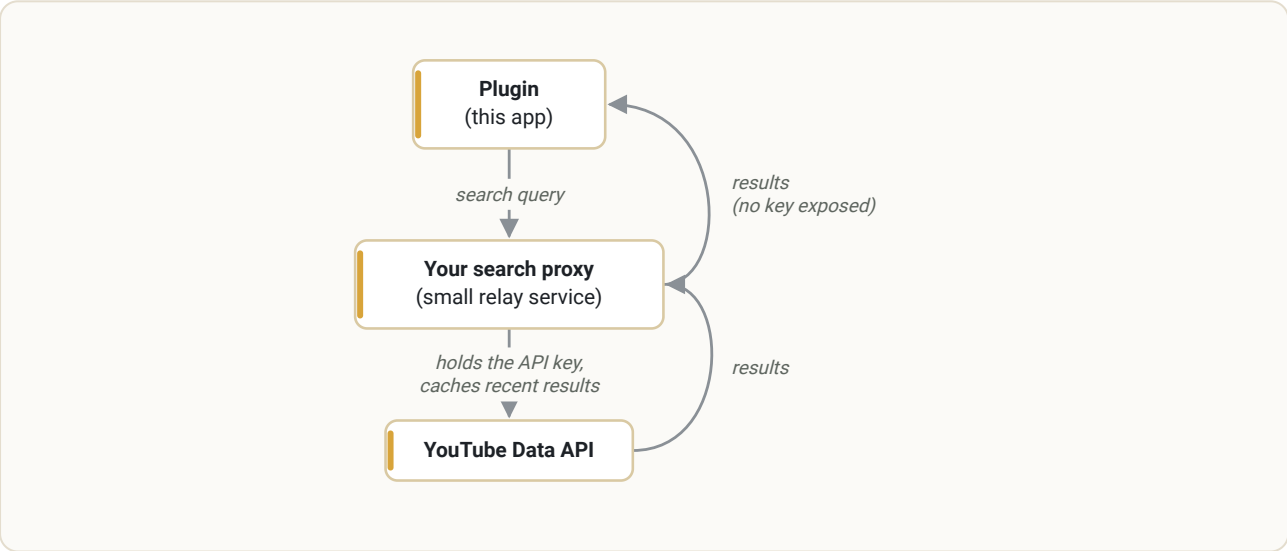
- **Watch Folder...** — point it at a folder (your downloads, a "new samples" folder, wherever you drop fresh material) and its audio and video files show up in the crate automatically, re-checked every couple of seconds.
- **Folders inside it.** Its subfolders are listed first, with a folder mark; **double-click** one (or select it and press **Return**) to open it. Inside a folder, the top row **..** goes back up. You can nest them as deep as you like, but never above the watch folder itself. The path above the list shows where you are.
- **Add Files...** — add specific files to the crate directly, without needing them all in one watched folder. You can also **drag files or a folder** from Explorer onto the crate: a folder adds its audio and video (not its subfolders).

**Remove** takes an added file back out (watch-folder files aren't removable this way — they just reflect whatever's actually in the folder).

- **Search** looks through the watch folder and every folder in it, and lists each match with its folder (*Drums\Kicks\kick 1.wav*), so typing a folder's name finds what's in it. **Favorites** shows only starred clips, from every folder. Clear the search (and Favorites) to go back to the folder you were in. The sort box lists the crate **A-Z** or **Newest** first (newest file on disk, handy for fresh downloads).
- **Managing clips.** Select a clip, then:
  - **Favorite** stars it (a gold star in the list); click again (**Unfavorite**) to unstar it.
  - **Rename...** renames the actual file on disk (the extension stays the same). If the clip is on pads or a deck in this project, they follow the new name, so the project saves it. Other projects that use the file will look for the old name.
  - **Delete...** moves the actual file to the Windows **Recycle Bin**, after asking. You can restore it from there. If it's on pads or a deck in this project, the message says where. They keep their sound until the project is closed, but won't find the file next time. The **Delete** key does the same from the list.
  - **Right-click** a clip for all of the above, plus Play, Load to Pad, Send to Empty Pad, Send to Deck, Show in Explorer and Remove from Crate. Right-click a folder to open it or show it in Explorer. Folders themselves are never renamed or deleted from here.
- Click a file to select and preview it. Audio plays through the built-in preview voice; video files marked `[VIDEO]` play with picture and sound in the central preview pane. **Shuffle** picks one at random from the folder you're in and every folder inside it, opens its folder and previews it. **Play** replays/toggles the current selection (for video). With the list focused, the **arrow keys** audition the next/previous file.
- **Load to Pad** (or double-click) puts the file on the selected pad; **Send to Empty Pad** puts it on the first empty pad of the current bank. The line under the buttons shows how it's going ("Loading ... onto pad 3", then "Loaded ..."): a long video takes a few seconds.
- **Send to Deck** loads it onto the turntable deck and switches to the TURNTABLE tab once it's there — ready to scratch, or to chop onto pads with Deck Chop.
- **Videos work too.** All three load a video's **soundtrack**, exactly like an audio file: chop a music video, a live clip or a phone recording the same way you'd chop a record. A few things to know:
  - What plays is whatever Windows itself can decode: MP4 and MOV (H.264/AAC — almost every phone, camera and download), WMV/ASF, 3GP and 3G2, camcorder files (MTS, M2TS, TS), MPG, and MKV/AVI with common codecs. WEBM needs the free Windows codec from the Microsoft Store. FLV isn't supported (Windows has no reader for it); convert it with another tool first. Audio: WAV, AIFF, FLAC, OGG, MP3, M4A/AAC, WMA, M4B (audiobooks), M4R (ringtones) and MKA. If Windows can't decode a video's sound (or it has none), it's marked *can't play* and loading it tells you so.
  - A video whose sound is completely silent — a screen or webcam recording made without a microphone — loads, but you get a message saying it's silent.
  - The picture and the sound are decoded separately. If Windows can't show a video's picture in the preview pane, Local Files plays just the sound (marked *sound only*), and it still loads onto pads and the deck.
  - Surround soundtracks are mixed down to stereo.
  - Pads and the deck take the **first 20 minutes** of a very long file (a whole film would need gigabytes of memory). To keep all of it, convert it first (below).
  - Saving a preset or sharing a kit stores the soundtrack as a WAV, not the whole video.
- M4A and AAC audio files load too (also through Windows' own decoder).

## YouTube Crate

- **Paste a YouTube URL** (or bare video ID) and hit **Watch** to embed that video using YouTube's own player, right in the tab. This is view-only — nothing is downloaded, extracted, or saved, the same as embedding a video on any webpage.
- **Search YouTube...** searches YouTube directly by keyword instead of requiring you to already have a URL — type a query, get a results list, double-click one to jump straight into the **Add to Crate** dialog with the title/channel already filled in.
  - This needs a **search proxy URL** configured first (a small relay service — see below for why). Paste it into the field at the top of the search popup; it's remembered for next time. Until one's configured, the button still works but shows "No search proxy configured" instead of results — Watch/paste-a-URL keeps working either way, this only affects the *search* convenience.
  - Why a proxy instead of searching YouTube directly: a real YouTube search needs a Google API key, and a key baked into a program that gets installed on other people's computers can be extracted and abused. The proxy holds that key server-side instead — this plugin only ever talks to the proxy, never to Google directly.




- **Add to Crate...** tags the pasted video (title, artist, channel, genre, style, year, key, BPM) and saves it to your own local crate — this is what the filter bar and Up Next queue search over. Nothing is auto-populated; you tag what you add.
- The **filter bar** (Search / Genre / Style / Decade / Key / Mode / BPM min-max / Starred only) narrows your crate down; **Apply** runs it, **Clear** resets everything.
- **UP NEXT** ranks the filtered results by similarity to whatever's currently playing (genre/style/artist/channel match, era proximity, key compatibility, BPM closeness) — click any entry to watch it. **Shuffle** picks something at random from the filtered set; **Next** advances to the top of the queue.
- **Favorite** stars the current video (usable with the Starred-only filter); **Remove** deletes it from your crate entirely.
- Load to Pad isn't available here — a YouTube embed was never a local file to begin with, so there's nothing to load onto a pad.

## Convert

Batch-converts your own audio files and videos into audio files. The classic job: a folder of music videos or live footage in, a folder of WAVs out, ready to dig through.

1. **Add Files...**, **Add Folder...**, or drag files and folders onto the list. **Include subfolders** decides whether Add Folder (and dropping a folder) goes into subfolders too. Videos are marked `[VIDEO]` and convert to their soundtrack. **Remove** takes the selected rows out; **Clear** empties the list.
2. Pick what to convert to:
   - **Format** — **WAV** or **AIFF** (uncompressed, for any DAW or sampler), **FLAC** (lossless and about half the size), or **OGG Vorbis** (lossy, smallest; choose the **OGG quality**, 128-320 kbps).
   - **Sample rate** — keep the original, or 44.1 / 48 / 88.2 / 96 kHz.
   - **Bit depth** — 16-bit, 24-bit, or 32-bit float (WAV only; AIFF and FLAC go up to 24-bit, OGG has no bit depth).
   - **Channels** — keep, **Mono** (both sides averaged) or **Stereo**.
   - **Normalize peaks** — turns each file up or down so its loudest moment sits just under full scale (-0.3 dB; -1 dB for OGG).
   - **Trim silence at start and end** — cuts quiet lead-in and tail (anything below -60 dB), keeping a few milliseconds so soft attacks and decays aren't clipped.
3. Choose where files go: **Save next to each original**, or an **Output Folder...** (it starts as *Music\Boom Bap Converted*). With an output folder, **Keep folder structure** recreates each file's subfolders from the folder you added it from.
4. Press **Convert**. Files convert one at a time in the background — keep working in other tabs. Each row shows its progress and then *Done* (with the new file's name) or *Failed* and why. **Cancel** stops after the current block; nothing half-written is left behind.
5. Double-click a finished row to show the file in Explorer. **Watch Output Folder** opens the output folder in **Local Files**, so you can audition what you converted and load it straight onto pads or the deck.

Nothing is ever overwritten: if a file with the same name already exists (including the original itself), the new one gets a number, like `Break (2).wav`. Pressing **Convert** again converts only what hasn't succeeded yet; once everything has, it converts the whole list again (handy for making the same files in a second format). Your settings are remembered for next time.

CHAPTER 18

# MIDI Learn

Right-click any DSP knob, toggle, the Volume slider, or the Swing slider, and choose **MIDI Learn** — then move a control on your MIDI hardware (a knob, fader, or similar) to bind it. Right-click the same control again and choose **Clear MIDI Learn** to unbind it. Bindings persist with your saved state (project/preset), same as everything else.

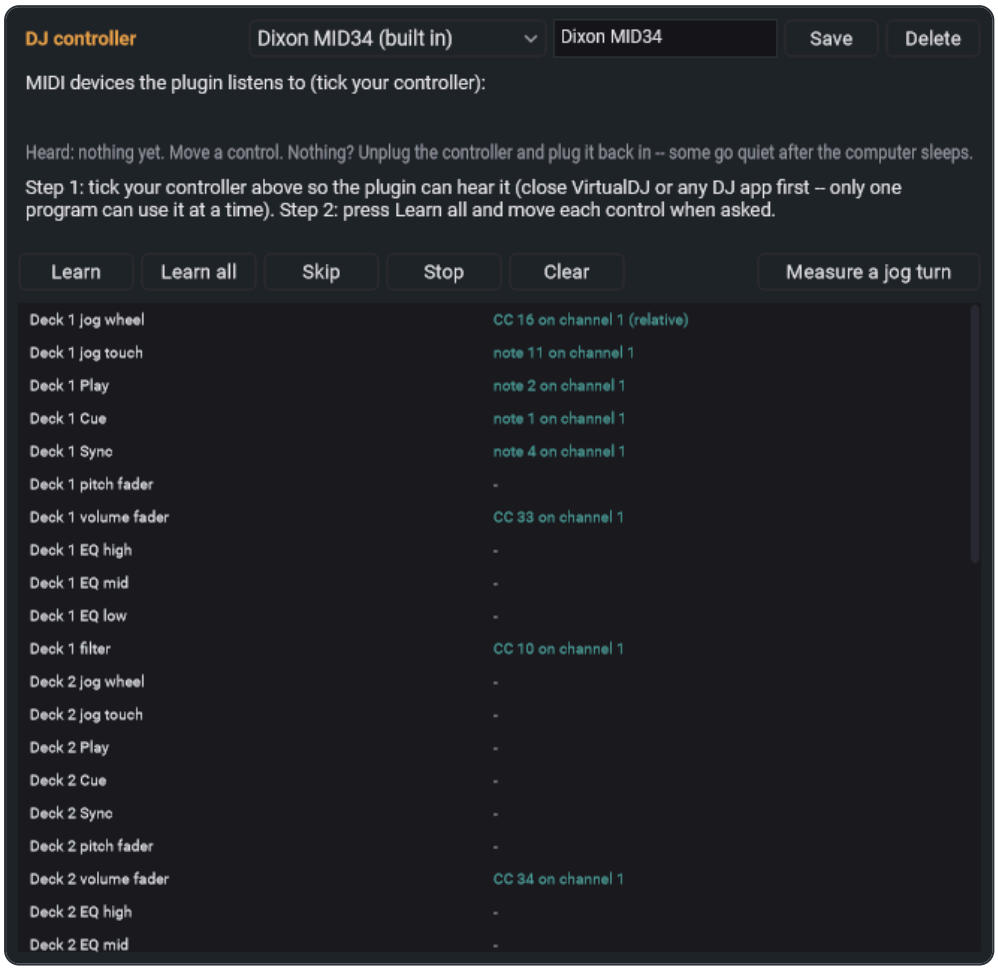



*MIDI Map*

**MIDI Map** (toolbar button) opens a single popup listing every active binding across the whole plugin — every learned knob and toggle, on every tab — so you can review or clear a mapping without hunting down whichever control it's attached to.

CHAPTER 19

# Using a DJ controller




*The Controller window*

**In one line:** teach the plugin your DJ controller once, and its jog wheels, buttons, faders and pads play the two decks and the pads.

Most DJ controllers only work out of the box inside the DJ app they came with. The **DJ Controller** button on the TURNTABLE tab (and **Controller** in the toolbar, next to **MIDI Map**) opens a window where you switch your controller on and teach the plugin your controller yourself: it asks you to move each control, works out what that control sends, and remembers it. You can save the result as a named controller and it's there next time, in the Standalone and in your DAW.

## Controllers that work straight away

Some controllers need no teaching at all. Plug one in and open the Standalone: the plugin switches it on by itself, its buttons light up briefly to say it's connected, and its jog, buttons, faders and pads work at once.

| Controller | What drives what |
|---|---|
| **Dixon MID34** (Windows calls it "MIDI34") | **DECK A/B** chooses which deck the jog, **CUE**, **PLAY**, **SYNC** and the pads play (it lights up for deck 2, and deck 2 comes on screen). The jog scratches that deck (touch the top to grab the record; hold **SHIFT** to search through it quickly); turning the jog's **edge** while it plays nudges it faster or slower for a moment, to line up a beat. The side faders are the two decks' volumes, the side knobs their filters; the crossfader; **BROWSE** and **LOAD** pick files (see Browsing from the controller); the side buttons choose what the 8 performance pads do -- see Pad modes. |

Your own saved controller always wins: teach a built-in one differently and save it, or pick another from **Saved controllers**. In a DAW the built-in layout is picked for you too when the controller is plugged in (since version 1.154.0); the DAW, not the plugin, decides which devices it hears, so switch the controller on in your DAW's MIDI settings and send it to the plugin's track.

## Pad modes (Dixon MID34)

The buttons down the sides of the MID34 choose what its 8 performance pads do. The button of the mode you're in lights up, and so do the pads that do something in it. Everything acts on the deck **DECK A/B** chose.

| Button | The pads | With SHIFT held |
|---|---|---|
| **SAMPLER** (where it starts) | play pads 1-8 | SHIFT + pad plays pads 9-16. SHIFT + SAMPLER switches **tempo adjust** on or off: while SAMPLER blinks, the jog changes the deck's tempo instead of moving the record |
| **HOT CUE** | jump to hot cues 1-8, or set one where the record is if it's empty (lit = set) | SHIFT + pad deletes that hot cue. SHIFT + HOT CUE = **saved loops**: an empty pad saves the running loop (or a loop from where the record is), a lit pad plays it again, SHIFT + pad clears it. They're saved with your project, like hot cues, and a new record on the deck starts with none |
| **LOOP** | top row: loop 4, 8, 16 or 32 beats (press the lit one again to stop looping); bottom row: jump back 4 / 1, forward 1 / 4 beats | SHIFT + LOOP = **roll**: hold a pad to stutter at 1/4, 1/8, 1/16 or 1/32 |
| **STEMS** | with the record's stems (see below): top row vocals, drums, bass and other on or off, bottom row that part on its own (again: all back). Without them: the record's bass, mids and highs | SHIFT + STEMS = **beat jump**: top row back 1, 2, 4, 8 beats, bottom row forward 1, 2, 4, 8 |
| **FX ON** | Brake, Spinback, Censor (while held), Stutter (while held) | SHIFT + FX ON = **FX page 2**: Reverb, Vinyl noise, Wow/flutter, Motor ramp (each on or off), low-pass and high-pass filter (while held), Slip, Censor (while held) |
| **SCRATCH** | the six scratch patterns: Transform, Crab, Flare, Orbit, Tear, Stab; pad 7 stops a pattern | SHIFT + SCRATCH switches **Slip** on or off |
| **SYNC** | matches the deck to the project tempo | SHIFT + SYNC puts the pitch back to normal |

STEMS works with the record's real **stems** -- vocals, drums, bass and other -- once you've split the record: press **Separate** in the deck's Stems section on the TURNTABLE tab (see Stems). A pad is lit while its part plays. Until the record has stems, STEMS falls back to frequency bands, the same split the STEMS tab uses: "bass" is the low end (kick and bass line), "mids" the middle (most vocals and melody), "highs" the top (hi-hats and air); a switched-off band comes back at the level it had.

## Browsing from the controller

Turn **BROWSE** to move through the sample browser (on the PADS tab). Press **LOAD** (or push BROWSE) on a folder to open or close it, and on a file to load it: onto the selected pad on the PADS tab, or onto the controller's deck on the TURNTABLE tab. On the TURNTABLE tab, where the browser isn't on screen, a small note under **DJ Controller** shows the file you're on.

## The controller's lights

The plugin lights your controller's buttons for you, the way DJ apps do: **Play** is lit while its deck plays, **Cue** and **Sync** while the deck has a record, and a **pad** while it holds a sound. When you close the plugin, the lights go off. Only buttons you've taught (or a built-in controller's buttons) are ever lit.

In a DAW (since version 1.154.0) this works too, with two differences: the lights come on once you've opened the plugin's window (so a DAW scanning its plugins never lights up your controller), and with several copies of the plugin in a project, the first one you open drives them. If they stay dark, your DAW may be holding the controller's output for itself: in its MIDI settings, switch the controller's *output* off there (its input stays on).

## Step 1: switch your controller on

- **If the plugin can't hear it, close your DJ app.** On some Windows setups only one program at a time can use a MIDI device.
- **Standalone:** open the controller window (**DJ Controller** on the TURNTABLE tab). The top of the window lists your MIDI devices: tick your controller. The Standalone remembers it for next time. If it won't stay ticked, another program is using it: close that program and tick it again.
- **In a DAW:** switch the controller on in your DAW's MIDI settings and send it to the track the plugin is on. The plugin only hears the MIDI its track gets.

Then move a knob or press a button on the controller. The **Heard** line under the devices shows the last thing the plugin received, for example "Heard just now from MIDI34: CC 16 on channel 1". If it still says "nothing yet", the controller's MIDI isn't reaching the plugin, and nothing below will work until it does. **Unplug the controller and plug it back in:** some controllers go quiet after the computer sleeps, even in their own DJ app, and a replug wakes them. The Standalone picks it up again by itself.

## Step 2: teach it your controller

1. In the same window, the list shows every control the plugin can drive: for each deck the **jog wheel**, **jog touch**, **Play**, **Cue**, **Sync**, **pitch fader**, **volume fader**, **EQ high / mid / low** and **filter**; then the **Crossfader**; then **Pads 1-16**.
2. Press **Learn all**. The window tells you which control to move next:
    - **buttons** (Play, Cue, Sync, pads): press it once;

- **faders and knobs**: move it from one end to the other;
- **jog wheels**: turn it back and forth for a couple of seconds, turning the top of the platter;
- **jog touch**: touch the top of the platter, then let go.

3. When it has what it needs it says **Got it**, shows what it heard, and moves on by itself. A control your controller doesn't have? Press **Skip**. Want to stop part way? Press **Stop**. What you've learned so far already works.
4. Press **Save** to keep it. Give it a name first if you like (it starts as "My controller").

To teach or re-teach one control, select it and press **Learn** (or double-click it). **Clear** forgets the selected control.

While the window is listening, the controller only teaches: nothing plays. As soon as it stops listening, everything you've taught it works. The window can stay open while you try it out: the decks and pads still respond to your mouse and to the controller.

### Measure a jog turn

After the jog wheel is learned, press **Measure a jog turn**, put a finger on a mark on Deck 1's platter, turn it exactly one full turn clockwise and press **Done**. From then on one turn of your jog wheel moves the record the same as one turn of a real 33 rpm record (1.8 seconds of audio). Without this, the plugin uses a fixed step per tick. That still works, but the record may move faster or slower than your hand.

## What each control does

| Control | What it does |
|---|---|
| Jog wheel | Scratches the deck. With **jog touch** learned, only a touched platter scratches, and turning the edge of the wheel does nothing. Without jog touch, turning the wheel grabs the record, and it's let go a moment after you stop turning. |
| Jog touch | Grabs the record while your hand is on the platter, and lets it go when you lift off, like holding a real one. |
| Play | Starts or stops the deck. |
| Cue | Stops the deck and jumps back to the start. |
| Sync | Matches the deck's pitch to the project tempo (the same as the deck's own Sync). |
| Pitch, Volume, EQ high/mid/low, Filter | Move the deck's own controls. |
| Crossfader | Moves the crossfader between the two decks. |
| Pads 1-16 | Play the pads exactly as a pad controller would. Velocity-sensitive pads play soft and loud, and Live Pad Quantize, Tap Pads and recording into the pattern all apply. |

The on-screen controls follow your hardware, and your DAW can record the fader and knob moves as automation.

## Good to know

- **Two decks that send the same numbers.** Many controllers send the same message for both decks and only change the MIDI channel. That's fine: the plugin tells them apart by channel.
- **Jog wheels count in different ways.** The plugin works out which way your jog wheel counts while you teach it, so you don't have to know.
- **Extra-smooth faders.** Some controllers send a fader in two halves for finer steps (14-bit). The plugin spots this and uses both.
- **Everything else still works.** Anything the controller sends that you haven't taught it goes on to the plugin as usual: pad notes, MIDI Learn links, and the older fixed jog input (note 20 and CC 20) all keep working.
- **Several controllers.** Save each under its own name and pick one from the **Saved controllers** list. Picking one makes it live. The plugin remembers which one you used last. **Delete** removes the one you've picked (it goes to the Recycle Bin); built-in controllers can't be deleted.
- **Where they're kept:** `%APPDATA%\Boom Bap Producer Pads\Controllers\`, one `.bbcontroller` file each. Copy the file to another computer to take your controller setup with you.

## If something doesn't work

- **The controller did work, and now nothing reaches the plugin (or its own DJ app).** Unplug it and plug it back in; the Standalone picks it up again by itself. Some controllers (the MID34 among them) go quiet when Windows powers their USB port down to save energy. If it keeps happening, you can stop Windows doing that: in **Control Panel > Power Options > Change plan settings > Change advanced power settings**, set **USB settings > USB selective suspend setting** to **Disabled**. On a laptop that costs a little battery.
- **To see what the Standalone did with your controller**, open `%APPDATA%\Boom Bap Producer Pads\controller-log.txt`: it notes when the controller was switched on, when devices came and went, and (once a minute at most) whether anything arrived from it. If it says the controller was open but nothing arrived, the controller has gone quiet: unplug it and plug it back in.
- **"Nothing came through from the controller."** The controller's MIDI isn't reaching the plugin: the **Heard** line will say "nothing yet". Close your DJ app, then tick the controller at the top of the window (Standalone) or check the track's MIDI input (DAW).
- **"Couldn't switch on ..."** Another program has the controller open. Close VirtualDJ or any other DJ or MIDI app, then tick it again.
- **I can't find the Controller button.** It arrived in version 1.142.0. If your TURNTABLE tab has no **DJ Controller** button, install the latest version.
- **A jog wheel learned as a fader** (the record jumps instead of following your hand): select it, press **Learn** and turn the wheel back and forth, both ways, not in one long sweep.
- **The record moves too fast or too slow under your hand:** use **Measure a jog turn**.
- **A button does two things:** it was probably taught to two controls. Teaching it again to the one you want takes it off the other.

## Related guides

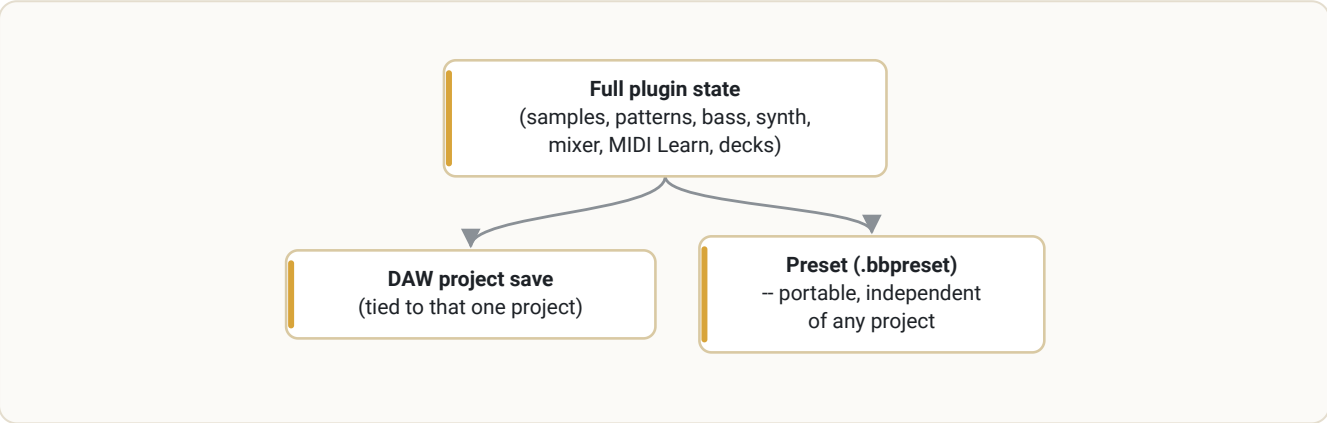
- MIDI Learn: link any single knob to hardware
- Turntable: the decks themselves, scratching and the crossfader

- Pad grid: what the pads do

CHAPTER 20

# Saving and the Standalone

Everything saves with your DAW project: every pad's sample and sound settings in all four banks, the patterns (with their pitch, length and groove), the bass line, the synth and its KEYS part, the arrangement, the mixer (levels, routing, buses and effects), MIDI Learn bindings and the decks' records — reopening the project restores everything, as long as the original sample files haven't moved or been deleted. Presets (Save/Load in the toolbar) capture the exact same full state as a portable, named file independent of any project — see The toolbar.




## Running as a standalone app

The installer's Standalone component (or a manual build's `Boom Bap Producer Pads.exe`) is the same plugin, running on its own without a DAW. On first launch, use its audio settings to pick an output device (and a MIDI input if you want to play it from a controller).

There's no DAW transport to drive the step sequencer in standalone mode, so the toolbar's **Play** button (or the **Seq Play** toggle next to Roll) runs it, at the tempo in the toolbar's **BPM** box (type it, drag it, or **Tap** it). It has no effect when the plugin is loaded inside a real DAW (the DAW's own transport is always in control there); pads, Roll, the turntable, and the keyboard/piano-roll all trigger normally in standalone mode regardless of this toggle.

## Your work is saved as you go

The Standalone keeps your session -- pads, decks, settings -- and brings it back next time you open it. Besides saving when you close it, it now saves every 30 seconds while you work (only when something changed), so a crash, a forced restart or a power cut costs you at most the last half-minute.

**Open it once at a time.** Two Standalone windows share one place to keep your work, so whichever you close last is what you'll find next time. If you open a second one, it tells you, and it doesn't save as you go -- close it and carry on in the first.

## If the Standalone closes unexpectedly

If the Standalone ever crashes, it saves a short **crash report** on your computer first: which version it was, what went wrong ("access violation", say) and where in the program it stopped. It holds no recordings, none of your files and no settings, and your Windows user name is taken out.

Nothing is sent anywhere by itself. The next time you open the Standalone, it asks what to do with the report:

- **Send report...** opens a new issue on the plugin's GitHub page in your web browser, with the report already filled in. Read it, add what you were doing if you remember, and submit it (you need a free GitHub account). The report is also copied, so you can paste it into an email or a message instead.
- **Not now** leaves it.
- **Don't ask again** stops these questions.

To read a report without sending it, open the folder: reports are kept in `%APPDATA%\Boom Bap Producer Pads\CrashReports` (the last ten). Delete them whenever you like.

In a DAW, the plugin doesn't do this: a crash there is the DAW's to catch and report, and a plugin mustn't take that over.

CHAPTER 21

# Languages

The plugin's text can be shown in another language. It ships in English; a language is a small text file that anyone can write, and the plugin picks it up by itself.

## Choosing a language

Press **Language** in the banner (top right, next to Light / Dark) and pick one. The plugin uses it the next time you open its window: in the Standalone, close it and open it again; in a DAW, close the plugin window and open it again. Your choice is remembered.

The list shows **English**, **Pseudo** (see below) and every language file in your Languages folder.

## Translating it into your language

1. Press **Language**, then **Make a template for translators**. A file called `template.txt` appears in your Languages folder (`%APPDATA%\Boom Bap Producer Pads\Languages`), and the folder opens.
2. Make a copy and name it after your language, for example `Francais.txt` (any name ending in `.txt`).
3. Open it in a text editor (Notepad is fine). Change the first line, `language: English (template)`, to your language's name, for example `language: Francais`. That's the name the Language menu shows.
4. Each line looks like this:

   ```
   "Load..." = "Load..."
   ```

   Replace the text on the **right** of the `=` with your translation, and leave the left side exactly as it is:

   ```
   "Load..." = "Charger..."
   ```

   A line you don't change stays in English, so you can translate a bit at a time. Inside the quotes, write `\"` for a quote mark and `\n` for a new line, as the template does.
5. Save the file as **UTF-8** (Notepad: *Save as* > *Encoding: UTF-8*), so accented letters come out right.
6. Choose your language from the **Language** menu and reopen the plugin window.

Almost everything can be translated. What stays as it is: the plugin's name in the banner, your own names (pads, presets, files), and a handful of labels built by joining pieces, where a piece like "Pad " (with its space) is translated on its own -- keep such spaces in your translation.

## The Pseudo language

**Pseudo** is for testing, not reading: every translatable piece of text shows up in brackets and about a third longer, like `[Load...~~~]`. Text that shows *without* brackets isn't translatable yet, and text that gets cut off shows where a longer translation won't fit.

CHAPTER 22

# License

Boom Bap Producer Pads is **free to use** — personal or commercial. You do not need to credit "Boom Bap Producer Pads" in tracks you make with it.

## What you don't get

- The right to redistribute, sell, sublicense, or rehost the plugin binary yourself — get it from the official source.
- The right to reverse-engineer, decompile, or extract the source code from a compiled build, beyond what applicable law permits regardless of this license.
- Ownership of the "Boom Bap Producer Pads" name, its UI design, or its bundled assets — those remain the creator's ("AdamNubian", distributed by "EdensFrequency").
- Any warranty. The plugin is provided **as is**, without warranty of any kind, express or implied.

## Credits

Built with JUCE.

The plugin's text is set in Roboto, built into the plugin under the Apache License 2.0. Roboto belongs to its authors, not to Boom Bap Producer Pads, and the terms above don't apply to it.

## Questions

For anything not covered here — licensing for redistribution, commercial bundling, or anything else outside normal end-user use — reach out to the creator directly rather than assuming; nothing here is a substitute for that conversation.

# Boom Bap Producer

Boom Bap Producer Pads 1.202.0

Free to use, personal or commercial.

Downloads, news and these guides: **edensfrequency.github.io/boom-bap-producer-pads**

Edens Frequency

edensfrequency.online